
THE
BOOK
THAT
WAITED
FOR
YOU

Chapter 1
The Girl Who Wrote Endings

Rain has a strange way of making the world quiet. It falls on the roads, the windows, the roofs, and the trees. It washes away dust and leaves tiny drops of water on every glass. But rain cannot wash away everything.

Some memories stay. Some questions stay.

And sometimes, the things we try hardest to forget are the very things that find their way back to us.

"You cannot change yesterday, but you can choose what you do with tomorrow."

That was the sentence written on a small wooden board near the entrance of an old apartment building. The board was almost hidden behind a climbing plant. The letters had faded because of years of rain and sunlight.

The building was called Moonlight Apartments. It stood at the end of a quiet street where very few people came after sunset. There were six floors. Each floor had four apartments. And on the sixth floor, behind a dark blue door marked 604, lived a seventeen-year-old girl named Luna.

The rain had been falling since evening. Luna sat beside her bedroom window and watched it. Her room was small. A wooden desk stood near the window. A warm yellow lamp sat on one corner of the desk. Books were placed in uneven piles around it.

Some were open. Some were half-written. Some had been closed forever.

In the middle of the desk was a notebook. Luna slowly turned the page. She looked at the last line she had written. Then she sighed. She did not like endings. Not in stories. Not in life.

She picked up her pencil and wrote another sentence. Then she stopped. She looked at it for a few seconds. Slowly, she crossed it out. "Still not right," she whispered. Luna had been writing stories for years. She loved creating people who lived inside her pages. She gave them houses. Friends. Dreams. Problems.

And most importantly, endings. In Luna's stories, every mystery had an answer. Every lost person came home. Every broken friendship was fixed. Every lonely character found someone waiting for them. She could give her characters the endings she wished real life had given her.

But lately, she could not finish anything. For the past few months, every story she started ended on the same blank page. Luna closed her notebook. She leaned back in her chair. Outside, lightning flashed across the sky. For one short second, her room became bright.

Then everything went dark again. Luna looked at the clock. 11:47 PM. She should have been sleeping. Instead, she opened her laptop and checked her email. There was nothing new. No message from a publisher.

No reply from the writing competition she had entered. Nothing. She closed the laptop. On the wall above her desk was a small photograph. Luna looked at it. It was an old photograph. The picture showed Luna when she was very young, standing beside a woman with long dark hair.

The woman was smiling. Luna was holding her hand. Her mother. Elara. Luna had not seen her mother for many years. Elara had disappeared when Luna was little. Nobody knew exactly where she had gone.

There had been searches. Questions. Police reports. People had come to the apartment and asked Luna's father many things. But no answer ever came. One day, Elara was simply gone. And after years passed, people slowly stopped asking about her.

Everyone except Luna. Luna still remembered one thing. The night before Elara disappeared, her mother had come into Luna's room. She had sat beside her bed and gently touched her hair. Then she had said something Luna never understood.

"If you ever find a book that doesn't have a name, Luna, don't open it."

Luna had been too young to understand. She had forgotten the sentence for many years. Until recently. Now it returned to her dreams sometimes. A nameless book. A dark cover. And a voice calling her name. Luna looked away from the photograph. "Why did you leave?" she whispered. The room gave no answer. Only the sound of rain.

Tap. Tap. Tap. Then Knock. Luna froze. She looked at her bedroom door. Another knock came. Knock. She slowly stood up. "Who is it?" No answer. Luna walked to the door and opened it. The hallway was empty.

The lights above her flickered. She looked left. Nothing. She looked right. Nothing. Then she heard something. A soft sound. Like something falling. Luna followed the sound toward the stairs. At the end of the hallway, near the old elevator, something was lying on the floor.

A book. Luna stopped. She had never seen it before. It was completely black. Not dark blue. Not brown. Black. The cover had no title. No picture. No name. Nothing. Luna looked around the hallway. Maybe someone had dropped it. She picked it up.

It was surprisingly cold. She turned it over. Nothing was written on the back. She opened the first page. Blank. The second page. Blank. The third. Blank. Every page was empty. Luna frowned.

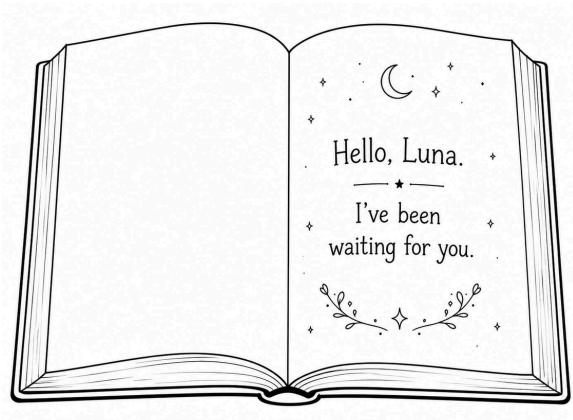
"Who leaves a book like this?" She turned another page. Nothing. Another. Nothing. Then she noticed something strange. There was a small silver mark at the bottom of the last page. It looked like a tiny crescent moon. Luna touched it.

The mark disappeared. She quickly pulled her hand away. Her heart began beating faster. "Okay…" She stared at the book. Maybe she was tired. Maybe the strange mark had only been a reflection. She almost closed it.

Then Letters slowly appeared on the empty page. One word. Then another. Luna stopped breathing for a moment. The sentence formed slowly, as if an invisible hand were writing it.

I have been waiting for you.

Luna stared at the words. She did not move. She did not blink.



The sentence remained there. I have been waiting for you. A cold feeling moved through her. She looked behind her. The hallway was still empty. She looked back at the book. “Who are you?” she whispered.

The letters did not change. For a few seconds, nothing happened. Then another line appeared underneath. Very slowly. Luna. Her own name. Luna dropped the book. It landed on the floor with a soft sound. She stepped back.

Her mind filled with one question. How did this book know her name? She wanted to run. She wanted to close the door and forget she had ever seen it. But something stopped her. Curiosity. Luna slowly bent down and picked up the book again. She turned the pages. The message was gone.

The page was blank. Completely blank. As if nothing had ever been written there. Luna stared at it for a long time. Then she noticed something else. A small sentence had appeared on the very bottom of the page. This time, it was not written in black. It was written in silver

Some stories wait for the right person to begin them. Luna's fingers became still. She looked toward her apartment. Then toward the dark hallway. For some reason, she felt that the book had not been lost. It had been left there.

For someone. For her. She carried it inside apartment 604 and placed it on her desk. The rain continued outside. The clock changed. 11:59 PM. Luna sat in front of the black book. She looked at the photograph of her mother. Then at the book. Something about them felt connected. She did not know why.

She did not know how. And she certainly did not know what the book wanted from her. But she knew one thing. For the first time in many years, Luna wanted to know how a story would begin.

She opened the black book again.

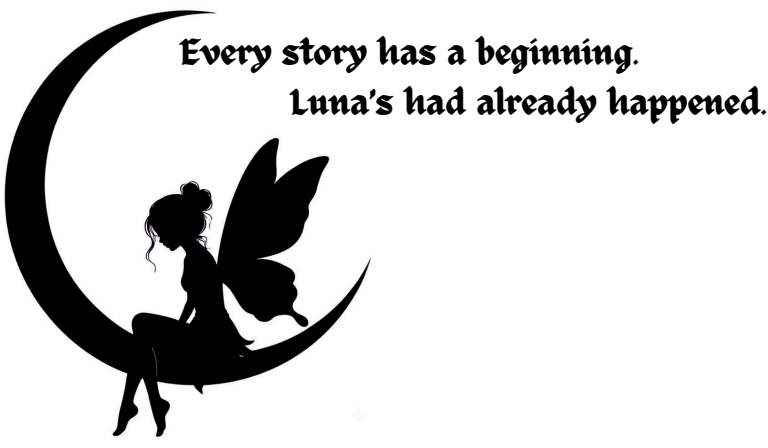
The first page was still blank.

Waiting.

And somewhere, far beyond the quiet walls of Moonlight Apartments, something seemed to wake.

Something that had been waiting for a very long time.

And Luna had just opened the door.



Chapter 2 - The Black Book

Luna did not sleep that night.

She sat at her desk for almost an hour, staring at the black book as if it might suddenly move. The rain outside had become softer, but the room still felt strangely cold. She looked at the clock. It was already past midnight. Usually, Luna would have been tired by then, but tonight her mind was filled with too many questions. Who had left the book outside her apartment? How had it known her name? And why had it written that it had been waiting for her? She picked up the book again and slowly turned the first page. Nothing.

The page was completely white. She turned the next one. Still nothing. She checked every page from the beginning to the end, but there was not a single word anywhere. No author's name. No title. No date. Not even a small mark that could tell her where it had come from. It looked like an ordinary empty notebook, except for one strange thing. The pages were not like normal paper. They were soft and smooth, almost like they had been made from something much older. Luna ran her fingers across one page and felt a tiny shiver run through her hand.

She closed the book and looked at the photograph of Elara on the wall. Her mother's old warning came back to her again. If you ever find a book that doesn't have a name, Luna, don't open it. Luna had always believed that the memory was something from her childhood that had become mixed with dreams. Maybe Elara had never said those words. Maybe Luna had created them herself after her mother disappeared. But now the black book was sitting right in front of her. A book with no name. A book that had somehow called her by name. Luna slowly reached for the photograph and took it from the wall.

She studied her mother's face. Elara looked happy in the picture, but Luna remembered something else about her. Her mother had always loved stories. She used to read to Luna before bed and make up little stories when there were no books nearby. Sometimes, Elara would tell Luna that stories were special because they could take people to places that did not exist. Luna had once asked her mother if stories could change real life. Elara had smiled, but she had not answered.

Luna placed the photograph back on the wall and returned to the book. She opened it again. The page was blank. She waited. Nothing happened. She touched the paper with one finger. Still nothing. She tried again with her whole hand. The room remained silent. Luna almost laughed at herself. "Maybe I'm just tired," she said softly. She closed the book and stood up. She was about to leave when she heard a very faint sound behind her. It was not a knock. It was not the rain. It sounded like the scratch of a pencil moving across paper. Luna turned around quickly. The black book was open on the desk. She was certain she had closed it. She walked closer. Her heart began beating faster. On the empty page, a single black dot had appeared. Then another. Slowly, the dots joined together and became letters.

You came back. Luna stared at the sentence. "I never left," she whispered. The words disappeared. A new sentence appeared. You always leave before the story begins. Luna frowned. She did not understand.

"What does that mean?" The page remained still.

She waited for another answer, but nothing appeared. Luna sat down and pulled the book closer. She suddenly felt less afraid and more curious. If the book could write by itself, perhaps it could answer her questions. She took a pencil from her desk and held it above the page. She did not know what she was planning to write. Maybe she wanted to test the book. Maybe she wanted to prove to herself that everything happening tonight had a normal explanation.

She placed the pencil on the page but stopped before making a mark. Then she remembered something she had written in her own notebook earlier that evening. It was a sentence about a girl who wished she could change one small thing about her past. Luna looked at the black book again.

"What happens if I write something?" she asked. Nothing. She waited. Still nothing. Luna opened a fresh page. The paper looked completely empty. She thought for a moment and decided to write something very small. Nothing dangerous. Nothing important. Just a simple wish.

She wrote: I wish tomorrow would be different.

The moment the final word touched the page, the room became completely silent. The rain stopped. Not slowly. Not gradually. It simply stopped. Luna looked toward the window. Every drop that had been falling a second ago was gone. The street below was still.

The trees were still. Even the sound of the old apartment building seemed to have disappeared. Luna looked back at the book. The sentence she had written was no longer there. Instead, another sentence appeared underneath it.

Be careful what you ask the story to change. Luna's eyes widened. She quickly closed the book. She did not open it again. That night, she finally went to bed. But sleep did not come easily. She kept thinking about the sentence. Be careful what you ask the story to change.

Eventually, her eyes became heavy. And Luna fell asleep. When she woke up, sunlight was coming through her window. For a few seconds, everything felt normal. She looked at the clock. 8:12 AM. She sat up. Then she remembered. The book. Luna jumped out of bed and looked at her desk.

The black book was still there. Closed. She walked toward it slowly. Before she could touch it, someone knocked on her apartment door. Luna froze. Another knock came. This time, she knew the sound. It was her father. She opened the door.

He stood outside holding two cups of tea. "Morning," he said. Luna stared at him. Something was different. She just could not understand what. Her father smiled. "You look like you saw a ghost."

Luna forced a small smile. "No. I just had a strange dream." He handed her a cup. "Then forget it. Some dreams are better left alone." Luna looked at him. Those words sounded strangely familiar. She walked back into her room and looked at the black book. For some reason, she suddenly remembered the sentence she had written.

I wish tomorrow would be different.

Maybe nothing had happened. Maybe the book was just an old notebook. Maybe she had imagined everything. Then her father spoke from the doorway. "Luna?" She turned around. "Yeah?" He looked at her for a moment. Then he smiled.

"Your mother used to make tea exactly like this." Luna's fingers tightened around the cup. Her father had never talked about Elara in the morning before. Not like this. Not so casually. Luna looked at the photograph on the wall. For the first time in years, she noticed something she had never noticed before.

In the photograph, Elara was not looking at the camera. She was looking at something beside Luna. Something outside the frame. Something Luna could not see. Luna walked closer to the photograph. Her heart began to beat faster. She turned around and looked at the black book.

The cover was no longer completely black.

A tiny silver crescent had appeared in the center.

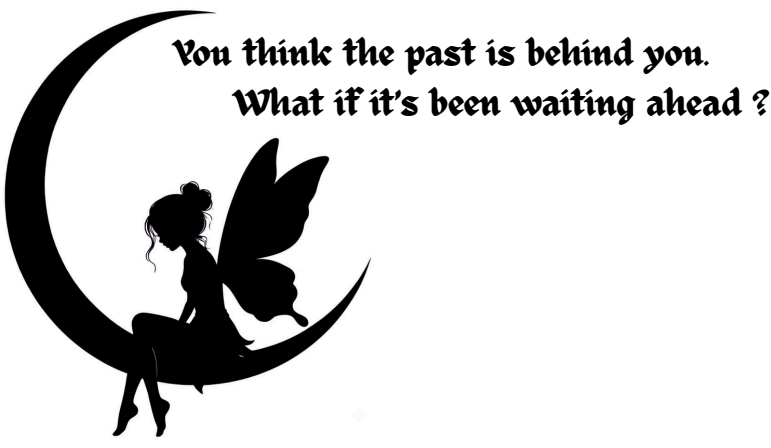
And underneath it, slowly, one word began to appear.

ELARA.

Luna stopped breathing.

Her mother's name was now written on the book.

And she knew, with a feeling she could not explain, that this was only the beginning.



Chapter 3 - The First Sentence

Luna stood completely still in front of the desk, staring at the name that had appeared on the black book. ELARA. She read it again and again, hoping that the letters would disappear the way the other sentences had disappeared before. But they stayed. Her mother's name was there, written in thin silver letters beneath the small crescent moon. Luna reached out and touched it. The moment her finger touched the cover, the letters became warm. She quickly pulled her hand away. Her room suddenly felt smaller than it had before.

The sound of the morning traffic outside seemed very far away, and even the sunlight coming through the window looked strange. Luna wanted to call her father and ask him what he knew, but something stopped her. She remembered the way he had spoken about Elara that morning. He had never spoken about her like that before. Maybe he remembered something. Maybe he knew more than he had told Luna all these years. But before she could ask him, the silver letters on the book slowly faded. The name ELARA disappeared, leaving the cover completely black again. Luna stood there with one thought in her mind: the book had not written her mother's name by accident.

She opened the book carefully. The first page was no longer blank. A single sentence was waiting for her in the middle of the page. Write something you wish could be different. Luna read it twice. Then she turned the page. The next page contained the same sentence. She turned another page. It was there again. Every page she opened carried those same words, written in the same neat handwriting. Luna frowned and closed the book. “So that's your game?” she whispered. “You want me to write something?” She waited, but the book gave no answer.

She opened it again and looked at the sentence. She thought about all the things she wished were different. She wished her mother had never disappeared. She wished her family had stayed together. She wished she had not spent so many years wondering what had happened. She wished her writing career was not failing. She wished she could stop feeling like there was an empty space in her life that nothing could fill. But she was not ready to write any of those things. They were too important. Too painful. So Luna decided to test the book with something small.

She took her pencil and sat at the desk. For a long time, she stared at the empty page. She wanted to write something that could not hurt anyone. Something simple enough to prove that the book was nothing more than a strange old notebook. Finally, she remembered the little café near Moonlight Apartments. Luna often went there to write, but every time she ordered her favorite cinnamon roll, it was already sold out.

It was a silly thing, but it was the first thought that came to her. She smiled a little and wrote, I wish there would be one cinnamon roll left for me today. Nothing happened. Luna waited for a few seconds. The words stayed on the page. She almost laughed. "Of course," she said. "I knew it." She closed the book and pushed it to the side. For the rest of the morning, she tried to forget about it. She took a shower, changed her clothes, packed her notebook, and left apartment 604. As she walked down the stairs, she kept thinking about the strange book. By the time she reached the ground floor, she had almost convinced herself that the whole thing was nothing more than a very strange dream.

The café was only a few minutes away. Luna pushed open the glass door and the familiar smell of coffee and warm bread filled the air. She walked toward the counter and looked at the display. There were only two cinnamon rolls left. Luna blinked. She usually arrived much later, when they were already sold out. She looked at the clock. It was still early. The woman behind the counter smiled.

“You're lucky today,” she said. “These just came out.” Luna stared at the cinnamon rolls. A cold feeling moved through her stomach. She slowly pointed at one. “Can I have that?” The woman nodded. Luna paid and sat at her usual table near the window. She did not eat the roll immediately. She simply stared at it. It was a very small thing. It could have happened naturally. Maybe the café had simply made more that morning. Maybe Luna had just been lucky. There could be a hundred explanations. But when she opened her notebook, she found a sentence she had not written.

One wish. One change. Luna immediately closed the notebook She looked around the café. Nobody was watching her She slowly took the black book out of her bag and placed it under the table. She opened it just enough to see the page. Her sentence was still there.

I wish there would be one cinnamon roll left for me today. Below it, a new line had appeared.

Granted.

Luna's hands became cold. She closed the book and pushed it back into her bag. For the first time, she understood that the book was real.

The next few hours passed strangely. Luna tried to continue writing, but she could not focus. Every small thing around her suddenly seemed important. When a bus arrived exactly when she reached the stop, she wondered if the book had caused it. When a stranger smiled at her, she wondered if that had been written somewhere too.

When the clouds disappeared and the sunlight became brighter, she wondered if even the weather could be changed. She hated not knowing where the book's power ended. On her way home, she decided that she needed another test. Something bigger than a cinnamon roll, but not big enough to hurt anyone.

She thought about one of her oldest memories. When Luna was eight years old, she had been chosen to read a story in front of her school. She had been nervous, forgotten her words, and cried in front of everyone. She had never told anyone how much that memory still embarrassed her. She had always wished that day had gone differently.

That evening, back inside apartment 604, Luna placed the black book on her desk and opened it. She stared at the blank page for several minutes. Then she wrote a sentence about that childhood memory. She did not ask for anything dangerous. She simply wrote, I wish that day had ended differently. The book remained silent for a few seconds. Then the words slowly disappeared. A new sentence appeared beneath them.

Which ending do you want? Luna stared at the question. She had expected the book to change something immediately. Instead, it was asking her to choose. She thought about the memory and wrote, I wish I had finished the story without crying. The book closed by itself. Luna jumped back. A soft sound came from inside it, almost like the turning of hundreds of pages at once. Then everything stopped. Luna did not know what to do, so she left the book on the desk and went to sleep.

The next morning, Luna woke up with a strange feeling. Something was different. She could not say what it was, but the feeling was there. She walked into the kitchen and found her father making breakfast. He looked at her and smiled. “Did you sleep well?” Luna nodded. Then, while reaching for a cup, her father suddenly said, “Do you remember that school competition you had when you were eight?” Luna froze. She looked at him. “What?” Her father laughed softly. “You were so excited that day.

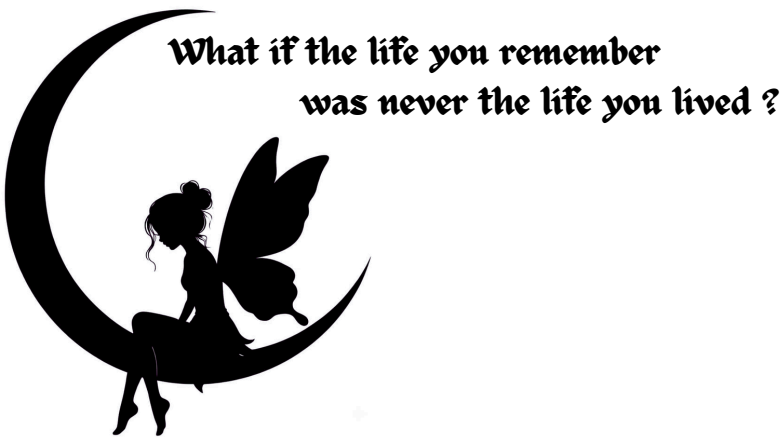
You went up on stage and read the whole story without a mistake. You even got a little certificate.” Luna stared at him. Her heart began beating faster. “I did?” Her father looked confused. “Of course. Why wouldn't you?” Luna said nothing.

She remembered the old version of that day. She remembered standing in front of everyone. She remembered forgetting her words. She remembered crying. She remembered coming home feeling ashamed. But her father remembered something completely different.

Luna ran back to her room. The black book was still on the desk. She opened it. The page was blank. The memory had changed. Not only inside her father's mind. The world had changed with it. Luna sat down slowly.

She finally understood the first rule of the book. It did not simply write stories. It did not simply make wishes come true. It changed reality. And somewhere inside the black book, beneath the pages Luna had already touched, another sentence was waiting.

She just hadn't reached it yet.



Chapter 4
A Life That Changed Overnight

Luna sat at her desk without moving. The black book was open in front of her, but she was no longer looking at the words on the page. Her mind was somewhere else, somewhere between the memory she had always known and the memory that now seemed to belong to her life. She could still remember standing in front of her school classroom when she was eight years old, holding a piece of paper with shaking hands. She remembered the faces of the other children. She remembered forgetting the words.

She remembered the terrible feeling in her chest when everyone began looking at her. That memory had stayed with her for years. It had become one of those small moments that quietly followed her wherever she went. But now her father remembered a completely different day. According to him, Luna had stood on the stage, finished her story, and received a certificate. There was no crying. No embarrassment. No forgotten words. Just a happy little girl who had done well.

Luna slowly opened the drawer beside her desk. She searched through old papers until she found a small box filled with childhood things. Inside it were birthday cards, school drawings, old ribbons, and photographs. At the bottom of the box, she found a certificate. She picked it up with trembling fingers. Her name was printed on it. Luna. First Prize — Story Reading Competition. Luna stared at it for a long time. She remembered never having won anything that day. Yet here was the proof that, according to the world around her, she had.

She turned toward the black book. "What did you do?" she whispered. The book remained silent. Luna opened it again and found the sentence she had written the night before. It was gone.

There was no trace of her wish. No record that the old memory had ever existed. That frightened her more than the changing memory itself. If the book could change the past, then maybe nobody else would ever know that anything had been changed. Only Luna remembered both versions. She suddenly understood why the book was dangerous.

A person could change something and everyone else would simply accept the new version as truth. Luna closed the book and pushed it away from her. She decided she would not use it again. Not even for something small. She wanted to put it somewhere safe and forget about it. But before she could close the drawer, her eyes fell on the old photograph of Elara.

Luna walked toward it and studied her mother's face. She tried to remember the last time she had seen her mother clearly. She remembered the bedroom. She remembered the rain. She remembered Elara sitting beside her bed. She remembered her voice. But there were parts of that night that felt strangely empty, as if someone had taken pieces of the memory away. Luna touched the photograph and whispered, "What happened to you?"

For the rest of the day, Luna tried to live normally. She went to the café, answered messages, opened her laptop, and worked on one of her unfinished stories. But nothing felt normal anymore. Every little thing made her wonder whether it had always been that way. When the café owner told her that she had been coming there for years, Luna wondered if that was true.

When a girl at the next table smiled at her and said, "I think I've seen you here before," Luna wondered how many memories in the world belonged to the old reality and how many belonged to the new one. She began noticing tiny changes everywhere. A shop that she remembered being blue was now green. A neighbor who used to live on the third floor was suddenly someone Luna had never met.

Even the photograph of her childhood school had changed. It was still the same school, but the playground looked different. Luna could not tell if these things had always been that way or if the book had changed them too. She began to feel as if she were walking through a house where someone had quietly moved all the furniture while she was asleep.

That evening, Luna returned to apartment 604 and placed the black book on the floor. She did not want it near her. She sat on her bed and stared at it from across the room. For almost twenty minutes, nothing happened. Then the cover slowly opened by itself. The pages began turning one after another. Luna stood up. She watched as the pages moved faster and faster until they suddenly stopped. One sentence appeared in the middle of the page. You remember the old story.

Luna's heart began beating faster. Another sentence appeared beneath it. They remember the new one. Luna walked closer. "Why?" she asked. The page remained still for a moment. Then another sentence appeared. Because you are the one who changed it. Luna shook her head. "I only changed one memory." The book answered with three words. Nothing changes alone. Luna stared at the page. She did not understand what it meant, but she knew she did not like the sound of it. She reached for the book, but before her fingers touched the page, the words disappeared.

Luna decided to test it one last time. She told herself that she needed to understand the rules before she could safely get rid of the book. She opened her childhood box again and found an old photograph of a birthday party. In the picture, Luna was standing beside a little girl from her neighborhood named Sophie.

Sophie had moved away many years ago, and Luna barely remembered her. It was a harmless memory, Luna thought. She wrote in the black book that she wished she had never lost touch with Sophie. She waited. The book did not move.

Then the words disappeared. Luna felt disappointed. Maybe the book only worked when she wrote about something she truly wanted. She closed it and went to sleep. The next morning, someone rang the apartment bell. Luna opened the door and found a woman standing outside with a little boy. The woman smiled warmly. “Luna! You probably don't remember me.” Luna looked at her face. She did not. The woman laughed.

“It's Sophie. We lived next door when we were children.” Luna felt the room tilt around her. Sophie had not simply returned. She had a family now. A life. A history that Luna suddenly seemed to share. Sophie spoke about childhood memories Luna had never experienced. She talked about afternoons they had spent together, games they had played, and a small promise they had made before Sophie moved away. Luna listened silently, unable to decide what frightened her more—the fact that Sophie was standing in front of her, or the fact that part of Luna now remembered her too.

That was when Luna understood the true meaning of the book's warning. Nothing changes alone. A single wish could create a chain of changes. One memory could change another memory. One person could change another person's life. One small sentence could create an entire story that had never existed before.

Luna hurried back to her bedroom and opened the black book. She searched through the pages, hoping to find an explanation. Most of them were still blank. Then, near the middle, she found something she had never seen before. There was a small drawing of a tree. Its branches spread across the page, and each branch ended in a different name. Luna recognized some names. Her father. Sophie. Herself. Others were strangers. At the very top of the tree was one name.

ELARA.

Luna's breath stopped. She touched her mother's name. The page became warm. Then, slowly, a new sentence appeared beneath it. Some stories are changed because someone is afraid to lose them. Luna stared at the words. She suddenly remembered her mother standing beside her bed years ago.

She remembered the rain. She remembered Elara's worried eyes. And then she remembered something else. Something she had completely forgotten. Elara had been holding a black book. Luna stepped away from the desk.

"No…"

The memory came back in pieces. Her mother had held the book tightly against her chest. She had looked at Luna. And before leaving the room, she had whispered: "Promise me you will never write my name." The room became silent.

Luna looked down at the black book. For the first time, she understood that the mystery was not simply about how the book had found her. The real question was much bigger. Why had her mother known about it?



Chapter 5
The Missing Memory

Luna could not move. Her mother's last words from that forgotten memory kept repeating inside her head. Promise me you will never write my name. She looked at the black book on the desk as if it had suddenly become something alive. Until that moment, Luna had thought the book was a strange object that had somehow found her. Now she began to wonder if the book had been part of her family long before she ever knew it existed.

She picked up the old photograph of Elara and looked at it again. Her mother's smile seemed different now. Not happier. Not sadder. Just different. Luna wondered how many things about her childhood she had forgotten. She closed her eyes and tried to remember the night Elara disappeared. She could see the room. She could see the rain outside. She could see her mother's dark hair. She could see the black book in her hands. But then there was a blank space.

A huge empty space in the middle of the memory. Luna could not remember what happened after Elara left the room. She had always believed that she simply fell asleep. But now she was not sure. She opened her eyes and stared at the book. Maybe the missing part of her memory was not missing by accident. Luna decided she needed answers before using the book again. She took out a notebook and began writing down everything she knew.

Her mother disappeared when she was young. Elara knew about the black book. Elara had warned Luna never to write her name. The book could change reality. And Luna was somehow able to remember the world before the changes. She underlined the last point several times. Why could she remember?

She had changed one small memory, yet nobody else remembered the old version. Maybe that was the book's rule. Maybe the person who wrote the change was the only person who could see both stories. Luna looked at the page and wrote one question in large letters: What happens when you change something bigger? She stared at the question for a long time. She knew she should not test it.

She knew the book was dangerous. But another part of her wanted to know how far its power went. If she could change a small memory, perhaps she could change something much bigger. Perhaps she could bring back something that had been lost. Perhaps she could even bring back Elara.

Luna immediately stopped herself. She remembered her mother's warning. Never write my name. She closed the notebook and pushed it away. “No,” she whispered. “I'm not doing that.” Instead, she decided to test the book using a memory that did not involve her family. She wanted to understand exactly what would happen when she changed something from her past. She searched through her childhood memories and found one that seemed unimportant.

When Luna was ten, she had once lost a small silver music box that her grandmother had given her. She had searched everywhere for it but never found it. It was not something she thought about often. If the book changed that memory, perhaps the result would be small enough to understand. Luna opened the black book and wrote carefully: I wish I had never lost the silver music box. The words stayed on the page for a few seconds. Then they slowly faded. The book closed by itself. Luna waited. Nothing happened. She almost felt relieved. Maybe the book had stopped working. Maybe she had finally reached its limit.

Then she heard a sound from the living room. A small metallic melody. Luna froze.

She knew that sound.

She ran out of her bedroom and saw her father standing beside the old wooden cabinet. In his hands was a small silver music box. The lid was open, and a familiar tune was playing softly. Luna stared at it. Her father looked at her and smiled. “I found this while cleaning the cupboard,” he said. “Do you remember it?” Luna slowly walked toward him. She remembered the music box. She remembered losing it. She remembered crying because she thought it was gone forever. But now her father spoke as if she had never lost it.

“You kept this with you for years,” he said. “You used to carry it everywhere.” Luna looked at the music box. There was a tiny scratch on its side. She remembered that scratch. She also remembered the day it disappeared. Both memories were inside her mind now. She remembered losing it. And she remembered never losing it. Two versions of the same life existed inside her head.

Luna took the music box from her father's hands and returned to her room. She placed it beside the black book. She stared at both objects. One was a memory she had changed. The other was the book that had made the change. Luna suddenly wondered what else had changed because of that single sentence. She had written that she had never lost the music box. But if she had never lost it, then the day she lost it had never happened. If that day had never happened, maybe her grandmother had never comforted her. Maybe her father had never searched the house with her.

Maybe another conversation had never taken place. Maybe another decision had changed because of it. Luna began to understand that even the smallest event could be connected to hundreds of other events. She had not changed one moment. She had changed a path. She opened the black book again. This time, a new sentence was already waiting.

Every choice has a shadow. Luna read it slowly. “What shadow?” The page remained blank. She turned it. Another sentence appeared. Look behind the memory. Luna's heart began beating faster.

She closed her eyes and thought about the night her mother disappeared. She tried to look beyond what she remembered. She saw Elara entering her room. She saw the black book in her hands. She heard the rain. She heard her mother's voice. Then everything became unclear. Luna pushed herself to remember more. She saw Elara place the book on the floor. She saw her mother open a page. She saw something written there. But she could not read it. The memory seemed to pull away every time she got close. Luna opened her eyes, breathing quickly. She realized that this was not an ordinary forgotten memory. Something had been removed from it.

She picked up the black book. “If you changed my memory,” she said, “show me.” The book remained silent. Luna tried again. “Show me what I forgot.” The pages began turning. Slowly at first. Then faster. The sound filled the room. Page after page moved beneath her fingers until the book suddenly stopped.

A single word appeared.

MIRA.

Luna stared at it. She had never heard that name before. At least, she thought she hadn't. She whispered it once.

“Mira.”

Something inside her mind moved. A tiny image appeared. A little girl. Dark hair. A yellow dress. Standing beside Luna in a garden. Luna blinked. The image disappeared. She touched the page again. “Mira?”

The book gave no answer. Then another sentence appeared beneath the name. You forgot her. Luna stepped backward.

"No."

The word appeared again. You forgot her. Luna shook her head. "I don't know anyone named Mira." The book remained open. Slowly, another line appeared.

You did. Luna looked toward the photograph of Elara. For the first time, she noticed something strange. There were three shadows behind Elara in the picture. One belonged to Luna. One belonged to Elara. And the third was much smaller. Luna moved closer to the photograph.

Her hands began to shake. There was someone standing beside her in that picture. Someone Luna had never remembered. Someone whose face had been carefully scratched out. She looked back at the black book. The name MIRA was still glowing faintly on the page. And beneath it, one final sentence appeared. She was never meant to be forgotten.



Chapter 6 - The Name Elara

Luna stood in front of the old photograph for a long time, unable to take her eyes away from the small figure standing beside her. She had looked at this photograph hundreds of times before. It had always been one of the few things she had kept from her childhood, a small piece of a life she could no longer remember clearly. But she had never noticed the third person. Never noticed the little hand resting beside hers. Never noticed the yellow dress.

Most importantly, she had never noticed that the girl's face had been scratched away. Luna slowly touched the photograph with her fingertip, careful not to damage it any further. “Mira,” she whispered. The name felt strangely familiar, even though she was certain she had never heard it before. It was like a word from a dream that she had forgotten after waking up. She closed her eyes and tried to remember the garden from the image that had appeared in her mind.

Green grass. A large tree. A little girl laughing. Luna standing beside her. Then a woman's voice calling them. Luna. Mira. Come inside. Luna opened her eyes suddenly. Her heart was beating fast. She knew that voice. It was Elara's.

She turned toward the black book. The page still showed the name MIRA, but something had changed. The letters were no longer black or silver. They were faint, almost as if they were slowly disappearing. Luna grabbed the book and held it closer. “Who is Mira?” she asked. The page remained blank.

“Why can't I remember her?” Nothing happened. Luna turned several pages, hoping to find an answer, but every page was empty. She tried asking again, louder this time. “What happened to Mira?” The book stayed silent.

Frustrated, Luna placed both hands on the desk and looked down. Then she noticed a tiny line at the bottom of the page. She had not seen it before. It was written in very small letters. Ask the person who remembers. Luna immediately thought of her father. If Mira had really been part of their family, then he had to know. She rushed out of the room, but stopped halfway down the hallway. What if her father did not remember? What if the book had changed his memory too? She suddenly felt afraid of asking him. Because if he looked at her with confusion and said there had never been a Mira, Luna would have no idea what to believe.

Her father was sitting in the living room, reading an old newspaper. Luna stood near the doorway for several seconds before speaking. “Dad?” He looked up. “Hmm?” Luna took a breath. “Do you remember someone named Mira?” The newspaper slowly lowered from his hands. It was only for a second, but Luna saw the change in his face. His smile disappeared. His eyes became still. Then he looked away. “Why are you asking?” Luna's heart began beating faster. “I found a photograph. There was a little girl in it.” Her father said nothing.

Luna walked closer. “Who was she?” He folded the newspaper carefully and placed it on the table. “Luna, where did you find that photograph?” “In my room.” “Show me.” Luna hesitated. Then she handed it to him. Her father stared at the photograph. His fingers tightened around its edges. He looked at the scratched-out face for a long time. Then he whispered a name so softly that Luna almost did not hear it. “Mira.”

The room became completely quiet. Luna felt as if the floor had disappeared beneath her. “You know her?” Her father did not answer immediately. He turned the photograph over and looked at the back. There was a date written there in Elara's handwriting. Beneath the date were three words: Our first garden. Luna looked at her father. “Who is she?” Her father closed his eyes.

For a moment, he looked tired in a way Luna had never seen before. “There are things your mother wanted to protect you from,” he finally said. Luna's voice became sharper. “Protect me from what?” He looked at her, but before he could answer, the lights in the apartment flickered. Once. Twice. Then they went out. Luna froze. The black book was in her bedroom. She could feel it somehow. A strange pressure filled the apartment, like the air had suddenly become heavier. Her father stood up. “Stay here.” But Luna was already moving toward her room.

The black book was open on the desk. Its pages were turning by themselves. Luna stepped closer. A soft silver light came from between the pages.

She saw her mother's name.

ELARA.

Then another name appeared beneath it.

MIRA.

Then Luna's own name.

LUNA.

Three names. Three lives. Three names connected by something she did not understand. Luna reached toward the page. The moment she touched it, the room disappeared. She was standing in a garden. Not an ordinary garden. The sky above her was a deep blue, but there was no sun. Small white lights floated between the trees like stars that had fallen from the sky. Flowers grew along a narrow stone path, and every flower seemed to glow softly in the darkness. Luna looked around in confusion. She knew this place.

She did not know how, but she knew it. She had seen it before. In dreams. In forgotten memories. Somewhere deep inside her childhood. “Hello?” Her voice travelled through the trees. No answer. She walked along the stone path. The further she went, the stronger the feeling became. This was the garden from her memory. The same large tree stood at the end of the path. Beneath it was a small wooden bench.

Luna walked toward it. Someone was sitting there. A woman. Long dark hair. A pale blue dress. Her back was turned toward Luna. Luna stopped. Her heart seemed to forget how to beat. She knew that person. She had spent years wondering where she was. She had imagined meeting her a thousand times. But never like this.

“Mom?”

The woman slowly turned around. It was Elara. She looked exactly as Luna remembered her. But there was something different in her eyes. Fear. Not fear of Luna. Elara stood up slowly. For a few seconds, neither of them spoke. Then Luna ran toward her. Elara caught her in her arms. Luna held her mother tightly, and all the questions she had carried for years disappeared for one small moment. She did not ask where Elara had been. She did not ask why she had left. She did not ask about the book. She was simply holding her mother again.

“I found you,” Luna whispered. Elara closed her eyes.

“No,” she said softly. Luna pulled away.

“What?”

Elara looked toward the black sky above the garden.

“You found the book.”

Luna stared at her. “What does that mean?” Elara looked directly into Luna's eyes. And then she saw the black book in Luna's hand. Her face changed. She stepped backward. “You shouldn't have come here.”

Luna felt a chill move through her.

“Why?”

Elara did not answer. Instead, she looked at the book as if she had seen something she had spent years trying to escape. “Luna,” she whispered, “how did you open it?”

Before Luna could reply, the garden began to change. The flowers started disappearing. The trees became transparent. The stone path cracked beneath their feet. Elara grabbed Luna's hand.

“Listen to me carefully.”

“What is happening?”

“You have to leave.”

“I just found you!”

“You don't understand.”

“Then explain!”

Elara looked at the book. Then at Luna. And with tears beginning to form in her eyes, she said the words Luna would remember for the rest of her life.

“The book did not bring you to me, Luna. It brought you here because it knows what you forgot.”

The garden shook. Something moved behind the trees. Luna turned toward the sound. When she looked back, Elara was already stepping away.

“Mom!”

Elara reached toward her.

“Find Mira.”

Then the entire garden disappeared.



Chapter 7
The Garden Behind the Pages

Luna opened her eyes with a sharp breath. She was back in her bedroom, sitting on the floor beside her desk. The black book lay open in front of her, but the silver light was gone. The room looked exactly as it had before. Her lamp was still on. The rain had stopped. The photograph of Elara was still hanging on the wall. For a few seconds, Luna could not understand what had happened. She looked at her hands, then at the book, then at the photograph again. Her mother's voice was still clear inside her mind. Find Mira.

Luna slowly stood up. She wanted to believe that what she had just seen was only a dream, but the wetness on her cheeks told her otherwise. She had been crying. She touched her face and looked at her fingers. Then she noticed something on her palm. A tiny white flower petal was lying there. Luna stared at it. She had seen those flowers in the garden. She had held nothing in her hand before entering that strange place. There was no way a flower petal from a dream could be sitting on her palm.

She picked up the black book and turned to the page where Elara's name had appeared. The page was blank now. Luna turned another page. Nothing. Another. Still nothing. She became frustrated and started turning the pages faster. Suddenly, a small line appeared in the center of one page. The garden remembers what the world forgets. Luna read the sentence carefully.

Then another line appeared beneath it. To find Mira, remember where the story began. Luna looked toward the photograph again. The words on the back came to her mind: Our first garden. She quickly picked up the photograph and turned it over. The date was still there, written in Elara's handwriting.

But beneath the date was another sentence that Luna had never noticed before. Where three shadows became one family. Luna's heart began beating faster. She did not know what it meant, but she knew the book was leading her somewhere. She took her coat, placed the book inside her bag, and quietly left apartment 604.

The streets outside Moonlight Apartments were almost empty. The rain had left the road wet, and the lights from the buildings reflected in the small pools of water. Luna walked quickly, holding the photograph tightly in one hand. She had no idea where she was going. She only knew that the date on the photograph was connected to something from her childhood. She tried searching her memories for a garden. There had been many parks and gardens near her old home, but one place kept coming back to her.

A small botanical garden at the edge of the city. Luna had not been there for years. Her father had once taken her there when she was little. She remembered a large wooden gate, a stone path, and a huge tree near the center. She had always loved that place. But there was something strange about her memory of it. She could remember herself standing under the tree, but she could not remember who had been standing beside her. Luna stopped walking. A tiny image flashed inside her mind.

A little girl in a yellow dress. A laugh. A hand holding hers. Then the image vanished again. “Mira,” Luna whispered. By the time Luna reached the botanical garden, the sky had become dark. The main entrance was closed. A large sign said that the garden had been shut for several years because the old greenhouse had become unsafe.

Luna walked around the fence, looking for another way inside. She found a narrow opening behind a group of trees and slipped through it. The garden was much quieter than she remembered. The paths were covered with leaves, and many of the flowers had grown wild.

Moonlight fell through the branches and made the whole place look like something from an old story. Luna walked slowly, following the memory in her mind. Left at the broken fountain. Right near the stone wall. Straight past the old greenhouse. She was surprised that she still remembered the way. At the end of the path, she saw the tree. It was larger than she remembered. Its branches stretched across the sky like long arms. Luna walked toward it and placed her hand against the trunk. A strange warmth moved through her fingers.

The black book suddenly became hot inside her bag. Luna pulled it out. The cover had changed. The small silver crescent was glowing again. She opened the book. Every page was blank except the last one. On that page was a simple drawing of the tree in front of her. Beneath it were two words: LOOK CLOSER. Luna looked around. There was nothing unusual. She checked the tree, the ground, the branches, and the old bench nearby. Then she noticed a small carving on the tree. It was almost hidden beneath the rough bark. Luna moved closer.

There were three initials carved into it. L. E. M. Luna touched them. A sudden memory rushed into her mind. She saw herself as a little girl, sitting under the tree. Elara was beside her. And on Luna's other side sat the little girl in the yellow dress. Mira. They were laughing. Elara had placed her arms around both girls. Luna heard herself saying, "We'll always stay together." Then Mira had held out her little finger. "Promise?" Young Luna had linked her finger with Mira's. "Promise."

The memory disappeared. Luna stepped back from the tree. She was crying again. She had remembered her sister. Not everything. Just one small moment. But it was enough. "Mira was real," Luna whispered. The book opened by itself. A page began filling with words. A memory can be hidden. Another line appeared. But it cannot be destroyed completely.

Luna stared at the words.

Then the ground beneath the tree began to glow.

A thin silver line appeared in the soil, forming a circle around the tree. Luna stepped away, but the light continued to grow. The old garden changed around her. The broken greenhouse became new again. The dead flowers began to bloom. The leaves disappeared from the paths. The dark sky became brighter. Luna looked around in shock.

She was no longer standing in the abandoned garden. She was standing in the garden from her childhood. The garden was full of flowers. Birds were singing. The old wooden bench was new. And somewhere nearby, a little girl was laughing. Luna turned toward the sound.

She saw Mira. She was running through the flowers in her yellow dress. Luna's heart filled with a strange mixture of happiness and sadness.

“Mira!”

The little girl stopped. She slowly turned around. For one second, Luna thought Mira would run toward her. But Mira did not. She simply stared at Luna. Then she looked behind her. Luna followed her gaze. Elara was standing beneath the old tree.

But this time, she was not alone. A tall figure stood beside her. His face was hidden in shadow. Luna could not hear what they were saying. Then the figure turned toward Luna. Even from far away, Luna could feel him looking directly at her. The black book in her hands suddenly opened to a new page. Three words appeared.

He remembers you. Luna's heart stopped. She looked back toward the tree. The tall figure was gone.

Elara was gone. Mira was gone.

The garden had become silent again. Luna stood alone beneath the tree. Then she heard a whisper from somewhere behind her.

“Luna…”

She turned around. Nobody was there. Only the black book. And on its open page, a final sentence was waiting.

“Some people disappear because they are forgotten. ”

A second line appeared beneath it.

“Others disappear because someone wants them forgotten.”



Chapter 8 - Mother

For a few seconds, Luna could hear nothing except her own breathing. The garden that had appeared before her was gone, but the feeling it had left behind remained. The words in the black book were still open in front of her: Some people disappear because they are forgotten. Others disappear because someone wants them forgotten. Luna read them again, trying to understand which one belonged to her family.

She looked toward the place where Elara had stood only moments ago. There was nothing there now except the old tree and a few white flowers moving in the night wind. Luna slowly closed the book and held it against her chest. She wanted to go home. She wanted to wake her father and demand every answer he had kept from her. But before she could take a step, she heard a voice behind her.

"Luna." She turned. Elara was standing there. Not the memory of Elara. Not a shadow. Not someone inside a photograph. Her mother was standing only a few steps away.

Luna could not speak. She had imagined this moment for years, but every version of it had been different. Sometimes she imagined herself running toward her mother. Sometimes she imagined asking why she had left. Sometimes she imagined being angry. But now, standing in front of the woman she had spent years searching for, Luna could do none of those things.

She simply stared. Elara looked older than she did in the photograph, but Luna knew her immediately. There was no doubt in her mind. The same eyes. The same smile. The same small mark near her left eyebrow. Elara looked at Luna as though she had been waiting for this moment too. Then she slowly walked forward and touched Luna's face. Her hand was warm. Real. Luna closed her eyes, and one tear rolled down her cheek.

“You're really here,” Luna whispered.

Elara smiled sadly. “I never stopped being here.”

Luna opened her eyes. “Then where were you?” Elara did not answer.

“Why did you leave me?” Still no answer.

“Why did everyone tell me you disappeared?” Elara looked down.

“Because, for a while, that was the safest story.”

Luna stepped back. “Safest for who?”

“For you.”

The answer made Luna angry. “You don't get to say that. You don't get to disappear for years and then tell me it was for my safety. I grew up thinking you were gone. I thought maybe you were dead. I thought maybe you didn't want me anymore.” Her voice broke at the last sentence. Elara looked at her with tears in her eyes. “I wanted you every single day,” she said. “There was never a day when I didn't think about you.”

“Then why didn't you come back?”

Elara looked at the black book in Luna's hands. “Because of that.”

Luna held the book tighter. “What is it?”

Elara took a slow breath. “It is a book that should never have found you.”

“But it did.”

“Yes.”

“Why?”

Elara looked toward the trees. “Because it has been waiting.”

“For me?”

Elara's eyes returned to Luna. “Yes.”

The answer made Luna feel cold. “Why would a book wait for me?”

Elara walked toward the old bench and sat down. Luna remained standing for a moment before finally sitting beside her. The silence between them felt strange. Luna had so many questions that she did not know which one to ask first. Elara seemed to understand.

“The book doesn't choose people because they are special,” Elara said quietly. “It chooses people because they are willing to write.”

“Write what?”

“Their wishes. Their regrets. Their choices.”

Luna looked at the book. “And then?”

“And then the book gives them what they ask for.”

Luna remembered the cinnamon roll. The school memory. The music box.

“But that's not all,” Elara continued. “The book does not simply change one thing. It changes everything connected to that thing. A single sentence can create a new path. A different past can create a different present. A different choice can create a different person.”

Luna thought about Sophie. “Mira…”

Elara became silent. Luna immediately noticed. “You know about her.”

Elara looked at the ground. “Yes.”

“Who is she?”

Elara closed her eyes. “She is your sister.”

The words were simple. But they changed everything.

Luna stared at her mother. “My sister?”

Elara nodded.

“You had a younger sister named Mira.”

Luna shook her head. “I don't remember her.”

“I know.”

“Why?”

Elara looked at the black book.

“Because someone made sure you wouldn't.”

Before Luna could ask another question, the garden began to change. The flowers around them slowly lost their color. The wind stopped. The moon disappeared behind dark clouds. Elara stood up immediately.

“We have to go.”

Luna stood too. “What is happening?”

“We stayed too long.”

“Who is coming?” Elara looked toward the trees. Her face had changed. She was afraid.

“Mom?” “Don't ask questions. Just follow me.”

They hurried down the stone path. Luna kept looking behind them. The garden no longer felt peaceful. The trees seemed taller. The shadows between them seemed deeper. Somewhere in the distance, Luna heard footsteps.

“Mom, who's there?”

“Don't look.”

“Why?”

“Because if he sees you, he will know you're here.”

Luna stopped.

“Who?”

Elara grabbed her hand.

“The First Writer.”

The name meant nothing to Luna. But the way Elara said it made Luna understand that it should. They reached the old gate. Elara suddenly stopped. Luna nearly walked into her.

“What?”

Elara turned around and held Luna's shoulders.

“Listen to me. When you return home, do not open the book again.”

Luna stared at her. “What?”

“Promise me.”

“But I need answers.”

“You will get them.”

“When?”

“When you're ready.”

“I am ready now!”

“No,” Elara whispered. “You think you are.”

Luna felt tears fill her eyes. “I found you after all these years. I'm not leaving without you.” Elara's face softened. “I know.”

She pulled Luna into a hug. For a moment, everything became quiet again. Luna held her mother tightly. Then Elara whispered something into her ear.

“I am sorry I couldn't be the mother you needed.”

Luna shook her head. “You can still come home.”

Elara slowly pulled away. “I can't.”

“Why?”

“Because I already made my choice.”

Before Luna could ask what that meant, the garden began disappearing. The trees faded. The flowers turned into tiny points of light. The stone path broke apart like pieces of glass.

Luna reached for Elara. “Mom!”

Elara held her hand. “Remember Mira.”

“I will.”

“And Luna…”

“What?”

Elara looked directly into her eyes. “Whatever the book promises you, don't let it choose your life.” The garden disappeared.

Luna fell forward. She opened her eyes on the floor of her bedroom. Morning light filled the room. The black book lay closed beside her. For several seconds, she could not move. Then she heard footsteps outside her door. Her father's voice called her name.

“Luna?”

She quickly sat up. “Yeah?”

“Are you awake?”

“Yes.”

The door opened. Her father stood there. He looked at Luna. Then at the black book. His face went pale. He knew. Luna slowly stood up.

“Dad.” He said nothing.

“You know about the book, don't you?”

Her father looked at her for a long moment. Then he whispered:
“I was hoping you'd never find it.”

Luna's heart sank. “And Mira?”

Her father's eyes filled with fear. He closed the bedroom door. Then he said something Luna had never expected to hear.

“Your sister isn't the only person the book took from you.”

Luna stared at him. “What does that mean?” Her father looked at the black book. And for the first time, Luna realized that her father was not afraid of the book. He was afraid of what Luna might remember next.



Chapter 9
The Woman Who Wasn't There

Luna stared at her father as if she had never seen him before. His last sentence remained between them, heavier than anything he had said that morning. Your sister isn't the only person the book took from you. Luna wanted to ask a hundred questions at once, but her voice refused to come out. Her father stood near the closed bedroom door, looking at the black book as though it might suddenly open and reveal everything.

"What did it take?" Luna finally asked. Her father looked at her. "I don't know if I should tell you." Luna felt anger rise inside her. "Everyone keeps saying that. Mom said it. You said it. The book says it. But nobody tells me anything." Her father lowered his eyes. "Because some truths are dangerous when you find them too early." Luna stepped closer. "I'm not a child anymore." Her father looked at her for a long moment.

"I know." Then he slowly sat on the edge of her bed. "But there are things your mother asked me never to tell you unless the book came back." Luna's heart stopped for a second. "The book coming back was part of the plan?" Her father shook his head. "No. We prayed it would never happen."

Luna picked up the black book and placed it on the desk. "Then tell me everything." Her father remained silent. Finally, he said, "Your mother didn't simply disappear." Luna waited. "She was trying to stop something." "The book?" she asked. He nodded. "Your mother found it years before you were born. She believed it was only an old magical book at first. She used it once. Just once." Luna's eyes widened. "What did she write?" Her father looked away. "I don't know." "You don't know?" "Elara never told me."

Luna became frustrated. “Then how do you know all this?” Her father took a deep breath. “Because I saw what happened afterward.” He told her that Elara had become frightened of the book. She began hiding it in different places and warned him never to touch it. She believed that the book was connected to people who had used it before. Then, one night, she disappeared. Her father searched for her for years. He found no body, no message, and no clue. The only thing left behind was a single page from the black book. On that page were two words: Not yet.

Luna walked to the wall and looked at the photograph of Elara. “Then how did I see her?” she asked. Her father looked confused. “See her where?” Luna hesitated. She could not tell him about the garden. Not yet. She did not know if he would believe her. “I thought I saw her,” she said. Her father stood up. “Where?” “In a dream.” He watched her carefully. “Luna, if you see your mother again, don't follow her.”

Luna turned around. “Why?” “Because if Elara is really where I think she is, then she is not alone.” The words made Luna remember the shadowy figure in the garden. She wanted to ask about the First Writer, but she stopped. Her father seemed afraid enough already. Instead, she asked, “What happened to Mira?” Her father's expression changed. “Mira was your younger sister. She was born three years after you.” Luna's eyes filled with tears. “Why don't I remember her?” Her father looked at the floor. “Because the memory was changed.” “By the book?” He nodded. “By your mother.”

Luna stepped backward. “Mom did it?” Her father shook his head quickly. “Not in the way you think. Elara was trying to protect Mira.” Luna's voice became quiet. “From what?” Her father did not answer. Instead, he walked to an old cupboard and opened a locked drawer. He took out a small metal box and placed it on the table. “Your mother left this for you.” Luna stared at the box. “Why didn't you give it to me before?” “Because she told me not to.”

He opened the box. Inside were several photographs, a silver key, and a folded piece of paper. Luna picked up the first photograph. It showed two little girls sitting beneath the garden tree. Luna recognized herself. Beside her was Mira. They were both smiling. Luna touched Mira's face. A strange warmth moved through her. For a moment, she could almost hear the little girl's voice. Luna, wait for me. She quickly placed the photograph down. Then she opened the folded paper. It contained only one sentence in Elara's handwriting: If Luna remembers Mira, the book has already found her.

Luna looked at her father. “What does that mean?” He shook his head. “I don't know.” She pointed at the silver key. “And this?” “That key was with Elara the night she disappeared.” Luna picked it up. It was small and old, with a crescent-shaped mark on its handle. The same mark as the one on the black book. The moment Luna touched it, the book opened by itself. A strong wind rushed through the room even though the windows were closed.

The pages turned rapidly until they stopped at a page containing a single drawing. It was the same garden. But this time, there was something different. At the far end of the garden stood a small wooden door. Luna had never seen it before. Beneath the drawing were three words: The door remembers. Her father stepped backward. “Close it.” Luna looked at him. “Dad, what is behind that door?” He shook his head. “I don't know.” “You're lying.” He looked at her sadly.

“I wish I was.” Luna took the silver key and held it above the drawing. The key began to glow. Suddenly, the room disappeared again. Luna was standing in the garden. But this time, nobody was there.

No Elara. No Mira. No shadowy figure. Only the wooden door. It stood beneath the large tree, exactly where the drawing had shown it. Luna walked toward it. The closer she came, the more familiar it looked.

There were small marks carved into the wood. Three names.

ELARA. MIRA. LUNA.

Luna touched the handle. The silver key fit perfectly. She turned it. The door opened. Behind it was not another room. It was a hallway filled with photographs. Hundreds of them. Maybe thousands. Photographs of people Luna had never seen. Children. Mothers. Fathers. Writers. Families.

Every photograph showed a different life. But there was something strange about every picture. In each one, someone had been scratched out. Luna slowly walked through the hallway. At the very end, she saw a photograph that made her stop. It showed her family.

Luna. Mira. Elara. Her father. Everyone was smiling. But someone had been scratched out from the photograph. Not Mira. Not Elara. Not her father. It's Luna. She stared at the picture in horror. "Why would someone erase me?" A voice answered from somewhere behind her.

"Because you were never supposed to remember." Luna turned. There was nobody there. Only another photograph lying on the floor. She picked it up. The picture showed a little Luna standing beside the black book. And beside her stood a tall man. His face was clear this time. Luna had never seen him before. But underneath the photograph was a name.

THE FIRST WRITER.

The hallway suddenly went dark. Luna dropped the photograph. When she opened her eyes again, she was back in her bedroom. The black book was closed. The silver key was still in her hand. Her father was standing beside the desk. He looked at Luna with fear.

"Where did you go?"

Luna looked at him. “To a place where the book keeps its memories.” Her father went pale. Then Luna slowly held up the photograph she had brought back. Her father saw the man in it. For the first time, Luna saw something she had never seen on her father's face before.

Recognition. He whispered one name. “The First Writer.” Luna stared at him. “You know him?” Her father did not answer. He simply looked at the photograph. And then he said: “I thought he disappeared a long time ago.”

Luna looked down at the black book. Its cover slowly opened. A new sentence appeared. He didn't disappear. Then another. He was waiting.



Chapter 10
The Girl in the Photograph

The word waiting stayed on the page long after the other words had disappeared. Luna stared at it, hoping her father would explain what he knew, but he remained silent. His eyes were fixed on the photograph of the tall man. Luna had never seen her father look so afraid. “Dad,” she said quietly, “who is he?” Her father did not answer.

“You know him.” Still nothing. “Please.” Her father finally looked at her. “I met him once.” Luna waited. “A long time ago. Before you were born.” He slowly sat down. “Your mother called him the First Writer. I never understood what that meant. I thought it was just a name she gave him.” Luna looked at the black book. “It isn't.” Her father shook his head. “No. It isn't.”

He told Luna that Elara had once spent months searching through old books and records, trying to understand where the black book had come from. During that time, she discovered stories about people who had written things into their lives and somehow changed them. Some stories were hundreds of years old. Some were only a few decades old. But every story had one thing in common.

Someone had mentioned a man who called himself the First Writer. No one knew his real name. No one knew how old he was. And no one knew where he lived. The only thing they knew was that he always appeared when someone wanted to change their life.

Luna listened carefully, but one question kept returning to her mind. “Why was I erased from that photograph?” Her father looked at the picture again. “Maybe you weren't erased.” Luna frowned. “Then what happened?” “Maybe the photograph is showing you a different version of your life.” Luna felt a chill.

“A different version?” Her father nodded. “Remember what the book does. It doesn't only change memories. It changes reality. Maybe, somewhere, there is a version of your life where you were never part of that family.” Luna looked down at the photograph. The thought made her uncomfortable. She had already learned that the book could change small things, but this felt different.

If the book could change a person's place in a family, then what else could it change? Could it change who someone loved? Could it change who someone became? Could it change whether someone existed at all? Luna suddenly understood why Elara had been so afraid. The book did not feel like a magical gift anymore. It felt like a door with no handle on the inside.

That night, Luna did something she had never done before. She placed every photograph she could find on the floor of her room. Childhood photographs. School photographs. Family photographs. Birthday photographs. She looked at each one carefully. At first, everything seemed normal. Then she noticed something strange. In one photograph, there were four people at a birthday party.

Luna recognized herself, her father, and Elara. The fourth person was Mira. In another photograph, Mira was missing. In another, Luna was missing. In another, both girls were there, but Elara was not. Luna began placing the photographs beside one another. It looked like different pieces of the same life had been mixed together. Some pictures showed one family. Others showed another. It was as if someone had taken several different stories and placed them inside the same box. Luna sat in the middle of them, trying to understand which version was real.

Then she found the photograph. It was smaller than the others and hidden inside an old book. Luna almost missed it. The picture showed two little girls standing beside the garden tree. Luna recognized herself immediately. The other girl was Mira.

But something about the photograph was different from the others. Mira's face had not been scratched out. She was looking directly at the camera, smiling. Luna turned the photograph over. There was no date. No name. Only a tiny sentence written in blue ink.

The sisters must remember each other. Luna's heart began beating faster. She turned the photograph back around. For the first time, she noticed something in Mira's hand. A small black book. Luna dropped the photograph. She picked it up again.

There was no mistake. Mira had been holding the same black book. That meant Mira had known about it too. Luna sat down on the floor. If Mira had used the book, then perhaps she had written something. Perhaps Mira had changed something. Perhaps the book had not erased Mira from Luna's life.

Perhaps Mira had erased herself. The thought was so strange that Luna almost laughed. But she couldn't. Nothing about the book was normal anymore. She opened the black book. A page turned by itself. A sentence appeared. Ask the question you are afraid to ask.

Luna swallowed. She knew exactly what she wanted to ask. "Did Mira write in this book?" Nothing happened. Luna waited. Then the answer appeared.

Yes.

Her heart dropped. "What did she write?" The page remained blank. Luna asked again.

"What did Mira write?" The book answered. She wrote your name.

Luna stared at the words. "My name?"

The sentence disappeared. A new one appeared. And then she asked the book to make you forget her. Luna felt the room spin. “No.” She shook her head. “That doesn't make sense.” The book remained silent. Luna looked at the photograph of Mira.

Why would her little sister ask a book to forget her? What could have happened between them? She searched her mind again. A garden. A tree. Mira's yellow dress. Her mother's voice. Then another memory appeared. Luna was crying. Mira was holding the black book. Elara was shouting.

And Luna heard herself say: “I don't want to remember.”

The memory disappeared before Luna could see anything else. She held her head. There was too much missing. Too many pieces. Too many versions of the past. Luna stood up and walked toward the mirror. She looked at herself. For a moment, she wondered if even her own reflection could be trusted.

Then something strange happened. The reflection smiled. Luna did not. She froze. Her reflection slowly raised one hand. Luna's hand remained at her side. The reflection pointed behind her. Luna turned. Nobody was there.

When she looked back at the mirror, everything was normal. But a sentence had appeared on the glass. Not written with ink. Written in fog. “You are remembering the wrong girl” Luna stepped closer. “What does that mean?” The sentence disappeared.

Another appeared. “Mira was not the one who was erased.”

Luna's breath caught. She looked at the photographs on the floor. Then at the black book. Then back at the mirror. “Then who was?” The mirror stayed silent.

For several seconds, Luna heard only the sound of her own breathing. Then the black book opened. A photograph slid out from between its pages and landed on the floor. Luna slowly picked it up. It showed a little girl standing alone beneath the garden tree.

Not Luna. Not Mira. Someone else. The girl was holding a black book. On the back of the photograph was a name. ELARA...

And beneath it, in handwriting Luna had never seen before, were four words: The first girl who wrote. Luna stared at the photograph. Her mother had not simply known about the book. She had used it. And if the photograph was telling the truth, Elara had been connected to the book long before Luna was born. Luna looked at the black book one more time. A final sentence appeared.

Your mother was not the first person to lose someone. Luna's fingers tightened around the photograph. The mystery was no longer about finding Elara. It was about discovering what Elara had done. And somewhere inside the pages of the black book, the truth about Mira was waiting to be remembered.



Chapter 11 - Mira

Luna sat on the floor for a long time, holding the old photograph of Elara in her hands. The words written on the back seemed impossible to understand. The first girl who wrote. Her mother had known about the black book long before Luna ever found it. She had used it. She had made choices with it. And somehow, those choices had led to Mira disappearing from Luna's memories.

Luna looked at the photograph again. She tried to imagine her mother as a young woman standing beneath the garden tree with the black book in her hands. What had Elara written? What had she wished for? And why had she been so afraid of the book afterward? Luna placed the photograph beside the others and slowly picked up the picture of Mira. She looked at the little girl's face. This time, instead of feeling like she was looking at a stranger, Luna felt something warm inside her chest. A memory was beginning to return. It was not clear. It was not complete. But it was hers.

She remembered a little yellow dress. She remembered two small hands covered in soil. She remembered laughing. And she remembered a voice saying, “Luna, look what I found!” Luna closed her eyes.

The memory became clearer.

She was standing beneath the garden tree. Mira was kneeling beside a small hole in the ground. Something shiny was buried inside it. Mira had dug it out and held it up proudly. It was a tiny silver key. Luna remembered taking it from her sister and pretending it was a treasure. Mira had laughed and told her that it was not a treasure. It was a key. “A key to what?” Luna had asked. Mira had pointed toward the garden. “Something that's waiting.”

The memory disappeared before Luna could see what happened next. Luna opened her eyes quickly. The silver key was still on her desk. The same key her father had given her. The same key that had opened the wooden door in the strange garden. Luna suddenly understood that the key had belonged to Mira first.

She picked it up and turned it over in her hand. There was a tiny mark on the back that she had never noticed before. A letter. M. Luna's fingers trembled. "You had this," she whispered. "Didn't you?" The room gave no answer. She looked at the black book. "Mira, if you're somewhere, please show me." Nothing happened. Luna waited. Then she realized something. She had been asking the book to give her answers, but perhaps that was exactly what the book wanted. It wanted her to keep asking. It wanted her to depend on it. Elara had warned her not to let the book choose her life. Maybe the first step was learning not to ask it for everything. Luna closed the book and placed it inside the drawer. She locked the drawer and kept the key in her pocket. For the first time since finding the book, she decided not to open it.

That evening, Luna went to the old garden again. She carried only the silver key and the photograph of Mira. The garden looked ordinary now. There were no glowing flowers. No strange lights. No magical doorway. Just old trees and a quiet path. Luna walked toward the large tree and sat beneath it. She placed Mira's photograph beside her. "I don't know what happened to you," she said softly.

"But I'm going to find out." The wind moved through the branches. A few leaves fell around her. Then Luna heard a tiny laugh. She looked up quickly. Nobody was there. She waited. Another laugh came from somewhere behind the tree. Luna stood up and walked around it. There was nothing. But on the ground, she found a small yellow ribbon. Luna picked it up. She remembered it immediately. Mira used to wear yellow ribbons in her hair.

Luna held the ribbon against her chest. Suddenly, another memory returned. She and Mira were running through the garden while Elara watched them from the bench. Luna was older, and Mira was much smaller. Mira was laughing so loudly that Elara had to tell her to slow down. Luna remembered turning around and holding out her hand. “Come on!” she had shouted.

Mira had run toward her. But then Luna remembered something else. A black book lying on the bench. Elara had been staring at it. Her face looked frightened. Mira had noticed it too. She had walked toward the book. Elara immediately stood up. “Don't touch that.” Mira stopped. Luna remembered asking why. Elara had looked at both girls and said, “Because some stories are not meant to be written.” Then the memory became dark.

Luna sat beneath the tree again. She finally understood that Mira had not simply disappeared from her life. Something had happened between the three of them—Elara, Mira, and the book. And Luna had been caught in the middle of it. But there was still one thing she could not understand. Why had Mira asked the book to make Luna forget her? If Mira had loved her, why would she choose to disappear from Luna's memory? Luna thought about the sentence from the book again. And then she asked the book to make you forget her.

Maybe Mira had not wanted Luna to suffer. Maybe she had been protecting her. Or maybe there was something much worse behind it. Luna returned home after sunset. Her father was sitting in the living room. He looked up when she entered. “Where were you?” he asked. “The garden.” His face changed. “Why?” Luna placed the yellow ribbon on the table. Her father stared at it. For a moment, he said nothing. Then he picked it up carefully. “I thought this was gone.” Luna sat beside him. “You remember her.” Her father looked at the ribbon. “I remember everything.”

Luna's eyes filled with tears. “Then tell me.” He took a long breath. “Mira was born after your mother started using the book. Elara believed she could protect both of you from it. But the book had already become part of our family.” Luna listened carefully. “One night, something happened. Mira disappeared.” “Where did she go?” “We don't know.” “Then why don't I remember her?” Her father looked at her sadly. “Because your mother made a choice.”

Luna's voice became quiet. “What choice?” Her father looked toward the locked drawer where the black book was hidden.

“She asked the book to take Mira out of your memories.”

Luna stared at him. “But why?”

Her father shook his head. “She believed it was the only way to keep you safe.” The room became silent. Luna slowly stood up and walked toward the drawer. She did not open it. Instead, she asked her father the question that was in her heart.

“Dad… is Mira alive?” Her father did not answer. Luna turned around. His silence was enough.

She took a step closer. “Dad.”

He finally looked at her. “I don't know.”

Luna's heart sank. Then the black book moved inside the locked drawer. Once. Twice. Then three times. Her father stood up immediately.

“Don't open it.”

Luna looked at him. “I won't.”

But the drawer slowly opened by itself. The black book slid forward. It fell onto the floor. And opened. A single page was waiting. There was no sentence this time. Only a name. MIRA.

Then, beneath it, a second line slowly appeared. She is not where you think she is. Luna stared at the page. Her father whispered, "Luna…" But Luna was no longer listening. Because beneath the words, another sentence was appearing. Slowly. Letter by letter.

"She has been waiting for you too."



Chapter 12 - What the Book Took

“She has been waiting for you too.” The words were still glowing on the page when Luna's father reached for the book. “Don't touch it,” he said quickly. Luna stepped back, but her eyes remained fixed on the name. Mira. For the first time, the name no longer felt like a stranger's name. It felt like someone Luna had loved. Someone she had laughed with. Someone whose hand she had once held beneath the garden tree. But the memories were still broken.

They came like pieces of a dream, appearing for a few seconds before disappearing again. Luna looked at her father. “You said you don't know if she's alive.” He nodded slowly. “I don't.” “But the book says she's waiting for me.” Her father looked frightened. “The book doesn't always tell the truth.” Luna frowned. “Then why should I believe anything it says?” Her father had no answer. He simply stared at the page. Slowly, the words disappeared. A new sentence appeared in their place. Ask what was taken. Luna looked at her father. “What did the book take from us?”

Her father sat down and remained quiet for a long time. Outside, the evening sky was turning dark, and the first drops of rain began touching the windows. Finally, he said, “The book took more than memories.” Luna sat across from him. “What else?” He looked at the black cover. “Choices.” Luna did not understand.

“How can a book take someone's choices?” Her father explained that every time someone used the book to change the past, the world had to create a new path. When one event changed, other events changed with it. People made different decisions because their lives were different. Some people remembered those choices. Others never knew they had made another choice at all. “Your mother discovered this too late,” he said. “She thought she could change one thing and leave everything else alone.

But every change created another change." Luna thought about the cinnamon roll, the school memory, the music box, and Sophie. All those small changes had already shown her what the book could do. But now she understood that the real danger was not the magic itself. It was what happened after the magic was used.

Her father opened the metal box again and removed an old piece of paper. "This is the last note your mother left before she disappeared." Luna took it carefully. The paper was folded many times, and the handwriting was faded. She opened it. There were only a few lines. I tried to save one child. I lost another. I tried to protect Luna. I changed her memory.

I thought forgetting would keep her safe. I was wrong. Luna stopped reading. Her eyes filled with tears. "Mom did this?" Her father nodded. "Elara believed that if Luna forgot Mira, the book would lose its connection to her." Luna looked at him. "Did it work?" He shook his head. "For a while." Luna looked down at the note. "And then?" Her father pointed toward the black book. "Then it came back."

Luna could not stop thinking about those words. Her mother had erased Mira from her memory to protect her. But why would the book come back now? Why had it waited all these years? Why had it chosen Luna again? She opened the old note and continued reading. The next line was almost impossible to see. Luna moved closer to the lamp. The book always returns to the person who was left behind. She read the sentence again. "What does that mean?" Her father shook his head.

"I don't know." Luna looked at him. "You keep saying you don't know." He sighed. "Because your mother never told me everything. She was trying to keep me away from the book too." Luna folded the paper and placed it on the table. Then she noticed something written on the back. It was not Elara's handwriting.

The letters were thin and neat. One memory can hide a person. It cannot erase the bond. Luna felt a strange warmth in her chest. She thought about Mira. Even though she had forgotten her sister for years, something inside her had still remembered. Maybe that was why Mira had begun appearing in her dreams. Maybe that was why the garden felt familiar. Maybe some part of Luna had been waiting for her without knowing who she was waiting for.

That night, Luna did not open the black book. Instead, she opened an old box filled with her childhood things and began searching for anything connected to Mira. She found drawings, ribbons, small toys, and pieces of paper. At the bottom of the box, she discovered a folded sheet of paper covered with childish handwriting. She opened it carefully. The writing was hers.

The letters were uneven because she had been very young. At the top of the page was a drawing of two girls standing under a large tree. Beneath them was a sentence written in bright pencil. Mira and Luna will always find each other. Luna stared at it. She did not remember writing it. Yet the words felt true. She turned the paper over. On the back was another drawing. This time, there was a black book between the two girls. A small red line had been drawn around it, as if young Luna had been warning someone not to touch it. Under the drawing were three simple words: Don't open it.

Luna suddenly remembered something. Not a full memory. Just a sound. Mira crying. Luna shouting. Elara saying, “Run!” Then the sound of a book closing. Luna dropped the paper. Her father heard the noise and came into the room. “What happened?” Luna looked up at him. “I remember something.” He stopped. “What?” “Mira was crying.” Her father went pale. “What else?” “Mom told us to run.” He slowly sat down. “Luna, don't force yourself to remember.” “Why?” “Because some memories are painful for a reason.”

Luna shook her head. “No. I need to know.” She closed her eyes and tried again. The memory returned like a small flash of light. She saw Mira standing in front of the black book. She saw Elara running toward them. She saw a tall man standing behind the garden gate. And then she heard Mira say something.

“If she remembers me, he'll find her.” Luna opened her eyes. She looked at her father.

“Who was Mira afraid of?” Her father did not answer. The silence told Luna enough. She looked toward the locked drawer. “The First Writer.”

Her father finally nodded. “Yes.”

Luna stood up. “Then Mira didn't ask the book to make me forget her because she wanted to disappear.”

Her father looked at her. “She wanted to hide me.”

Neither of them spoke. The black book suddenly fell from the drawer and landed on the floor. It opened to a blank page. Luna walked toward it, but this time she did not touch it. Words began appearing by themselves. Mira was not erased. Luna's eyes widened. Another sentence appeared. She was hidden.

Then another. And the one who hid her is still watching. The lights in apartment 604 went out. Luna and her father stood completely still. From somewhere outside the apartment came a soft sound. Three knocks.

Knock... Knock... Knock....

Her father whispered, “Don't open the door.”

Luna looked at the black book.

A final sentence appeared.

He has found you!!!



Not every distance means someone stopped caring.

Chapter 13 - The Previous Writers

The three knocks stopped. Luna and her father stood in the darkness of apartment 604 without moving. For a few seconds, neither of them even breathed properly. The black book remained open on the floor, its pages glowing faintly in the darkness. Luna looked toward the front door. A thin line of light from the hallway could be seen beneath it. Someone was standing outside.

Her father slowly walked toward the door, but Luna caught his arm. “Don't,” she whispered. He looked at her. “Stay here.” Before he could take another step, the knocking came again. This time it was softer. Almost gentle. Knock. Knock. Knock. Luna's heart beat faster. Then a voice came from the other side. “Luna?” She froze. She knew that voice. It was her own voice. The voice sounded exactly like hers, as if another Luna was standing outside the apartment.

Her father immediately stepped away from the door. “Don't answer,” he whispered. The voice came again. “Luna, I know you're there.” Luna stared at the door, unable to understand what she was hearing. Then the black book suddenly closed by itself. The room became completely silent.

Her father grabbed the book and placed it inside the metal box. “We're leaving,” he said. Luna looked at him in surprise. “Where?” “Somewhere the book can't reach us.” “Does such a place even exist?” He didn't answer. He took the old silver key, the photographs, and Elara's note. Luna quickly picked up Mira's photograph and followed him.

They left through the back staircase and walked several streets before stopping near an old building that Luna had never seen before. It looked like an ordinary library from the outside, but there was no name above the door. Her father unlocked it with the silver key. Inside, the building was much larger than it looked from outside.

There were shelves everywhere, reaching almost to the ceiling. Old books filled every shelf. Some were dusty. Some looked brand new. Luna looked around in confusion. “Where are we?” Her father closed the door behind them. “This is where your mother kept the things she discovered.” Luna slowly walked toward one of the shelves. “About the book?” “About the people who used it.”

Her father led her deeper into the library. At the end of a long hallway was a small room with a round wooden table. He placed the metal box on it and opened it. Inside were several old notebooks. Luna picked up the first one. Its cover was brown and worn. There was no title. When she opened it, she found page after page filled with handwriting.

Dates. Names. Places. Short descriptions of people. Some pages had photographs attached to them. Luna turned one page after another. Then she stopped. At the top of one page was a sentence: She wrote a new life for herself. Beneath it was a photograph of a young woman. Another page said: He changed the day he lost his brother. Another said: She wrote herself into a world where nobody could leave her. Luna looked at her father. “Who are these people?” He answered quietly, “The previous writers.”

Luna turned the pages faster. There were dozens of names. Some were from different countries. Some lived hundreds of years ago. Some had lived only a few decades earlier. Each person had used the black book for a different reason. One wanted to change a mistake. Another wanted to bring back something they had lost. Another wanted to become someone important.

Another simply wanted to know what their life would have been like if they had made a different choice. But every story ended in the same strange way. Their lives changed. Their memories became uncertain. Their names disappeared from ordinary records. And eventually, the writers themselves vanished.

Luna looked at her father. “They disappeared because of the book?” He shook his head. “Not exactly.” “Then what happened?” He turned to the last page of the notebook. “They disappeared because they kept writing.”

Luna frowned. “I don't understand.” Her father explained that the book did not have a limit. Once a person discovered that they could change reality, they often wanted to fix one more thing. Then another. Then another. At first, the changes were small. But slowly, the writer began trying to create a perfect life.

They would change a painful memory, then change the event that caused it, then change another event connected to that one. Soon, the life they were living was no longer the life they had originally known. It became a story built from hundreds of rewritten choices. “And what happens to the writer?” Luna asked. Her father looked at the old photographs. “Eventually, they become part of the story.” Luna felt a chill. “What does that mean?” He answered, “Nobody remembers which version of them was real anymore.”

Luna looked at the photographs again. One photograph showed a smiling boy standing beside his family. Another showed the same boy years later, but his family was completely different. Another showed him standing alone. Beneath the photographs was a handwritten sentence: Every rewrite creates a new version. Every new version needs a place to exist. Luna slowly understood.

“The book creates different realities.” Her father nodded. “And some of those realities don't disappear when the writer changes their mind.” Luna looked frightened. “Then where do they go?” Her father pointed toward the shelves around them. “Here.”

Luna stared at him. “This library isn't just filled with books,” he continued. “It is filled with the stories the writers left behind.”

Luna walked slowly between the shelves. For the first time, she noticed that many of the books had names written on their spines. She recognized none of them. She pulled one out. When she opened it, she saw a photograph of a little boy. The next page showed his house. The next showed his family. The next showed the same family without him. Luna quickly closed the book. “These are people's lives.” Her father nodded. “Lives that were changed.” Luna looked around. “Why did Mom keep all of this?” “Because she wanted to understand how to stop the book.” “Did she succeed?” Her father remained silent.

Luna walked back to the table. “What about the First Writer?” she asked. Her father's expression became serious. “He is different.” “How?” “The others used the book. He understood it.” Luna waited. “He discovered the book's oldest secret.” Her father opened another notebook. This one was much older than the others. The pages were almost yellow. On the first page was a drawing of the black book.

Underneath it was a sentence written in faded ink: The first person who writes becomes part of the book's story. Luna read it twice. “So the First Writer was the first person to use it?” Her father nodded. “At least, that's what your mother believed.” “And what did he write?” Her father closed the notebook. “Nobody knows.”

Luna looked at the black book inside the metal box. “Then why does he want me?” Her father looked at her carefully. “Because you are connected to something he couldn't control.” “What?” He didn't answer. Luna became frustrated. “Everyone keeps hiding things from me. Mom. You. Even the book.” Her father looked down. “Your mother wasn't hiding the truth because she didn't trust you. She was hiding it because she knew you would try to fix everything once you remembered.” Luna's voice became quiet. “Maybe I should.” Her father shook his head. “That's exactly what the book wants.”

Suddenly, one of the books on the highest shelf fell to the floor.

Luna and her father both turned. The book had opened by itself. Luna walked toward it slowly. There was a name on the first page.

ELARA. Her heart stopped. She picked it up and began reading. This was not a story about Elara's disappearance. It was a story about the first time she found the black book. Luna turned the page. There was a drawing of Elara as a young woman. Then another page.

A garden. Then another. A little girl. Luna froze. The little girl was Mira. But the next page made Luna's hands tremble. It showed Elara standing beneath the garden tree. Mira was beside her. And Luna was nowhere in the picture.

Underneath it was a single sentence: "Before Luna was born, Elara had already made her first choice."

Luna slowly turned the page. The next sentence appeared. She wrote a child into her future. Luna's eyes widened. She looked at her father. "Dad…" He said nothing. Luna turned another page. There was no picture this time. Only one sentence. Luna was not the first child the book knew. The lights in the library flickered.

Then every book on every shelf opened at the same time. Thousands of pages began turning together. And from somewhere deep inside the library, a man's voice quietly said:

"Now you are finally ready to read the first story."

Luna turned toward the darkness. A tall shadow stood at the end of the hallway. She couldn't see his face. But she already knew who he was.

The First Writer had finally come for her.

Chapter 14 - The First Writer

The library became completely still. A moment ago, thousands of pages had been turning at once, but now there was not even the sound of a single page moving. Luna stood beside the wooden table, staring at the tall shadow at the end of the hallway. Her father had gone completely pale. He slowly stepped in front of Luna, as if he could protect her simply by standing there.

The figure did not move. He stood beneath the weak light coming from the ceiling, his face still hidden in darkness. Luna could feel the black book inside the metal box behind her. It felt as though something inside it was awake. “Who are you?” Luna asked. The figure remained silent for a moment. Then he took one slow step forward. His face finally became visible. He looked neither old nor young. There was something strangely calm about him, almost like he had been waiting in that library for a very long time. His eyes moved from Luna to her father. Then he smiled slightly. “You already know my name.”

Luna's father immediately said, “Stay away from her.” The man looked at him. “You said the same thing to Elara.” Luna's heart jumped at the mention of her mother. “You knew my mother?” The man looked at Luna again. “I knew Elara before she became your mother.” Luna stepped forward despite her father's warning. “What did you do to her?” The man's expression did not change. “I did not take her.” Luna's voice became stronger. “Then where is she?” He looked toward the shelves filled with old books.

“She chose where she wanted to be.” Luna shook her head. “That's not true.” “You think people disappear because someone takes them,” he said quietly. “Sometimes people disappear because they are afraid of what they might become.” Luna remembered Elara's words in the garden: I already made my choice.

For the first time, she wondered whether her mother had truly been trapped or whether she had chosen to stay away. The man slowly walked toward the table. Luna's father moved to stop him, but the man raised one hand. Nothing dramatic happened. He simply looked at him, and her father suddenly became still. “You cannot protect her from the truth forever,” he said.

Luna's father lowered his eyes. “I promised Elara.” “And Elara made you promise because she knew the truth would lead Luna here eventually.” Luna looked between them. “Stop talking as if I'm not standing here.” The man smiled faintly. “Good. You have her courage.” Luna frowned. “Don't compare me to my mother.” “Why?” “Because I don't know who she really was.” The man's expression became serious. “That is exactly why you are here.”

He walked to the metal box and placed his hand on it. The lock opened by itself. Luna's father immediately reached for the box, but it was too late. The black book rose slowly into the air and opened. Its pages turned until they reached the very first page. Luna stepped closer. There was no title. No author's name.

Only a sentence written in faded ink: Every life begins with a choice. The man looked at Luna. “That was the first thing I wrote.” Luna stared at him. “You created the book?” He shook his head. “No. I found it.” Luna was surprised. “Then who created it?” “I don't know.” The answer sounded strange coming from someone who seemed to know everything else. “The book existed before me.

But I was the first person to understand what it could do.” Luna looked at the pages. “And that's why they call you the First Writer.” He nodded. “Not because I was the first to write. Because I was the first to understand the story.” Luna looked at the old books around them.

“What story?”

The First Writer walked toward a shelf and pulled out one of the oldest books. He opened it carefully. Inside was a drawing of a small village. "People spend their entire lives making choices," he said. "Some choices bring happiness. Some bring pain. Some choices take people away from us. And sometimes, one wrong choice can change everything." He closed the book.

"I believed that suffering was created by bad choices. So I wanted to remove the bad choices." Luna listened carefully. "You wanted to control people's lives." "I wanted to save them." "Those aren't the same thing." The First Writer smiled. "That's what Elara told me."

Luna's heart tightened. "What happened between you and my mother?" He looked at her for a long moment. "Your mother believed people should be allowed to make mistakes." "And you disagreed." "I believed mistakes were unnecessary." He walked slowly between the shelves. "Imagine a world where nobody loses the person they love. A world where every child grows up with their family.

A world where nobody makes a decision they regret. No loneliness. No fear. No guilt. No sorrow." Luna thought about her mother. About Mira. About all the years she had spent wondering what happened to them. "That sounds perfect," she whispered. "It is," he replied. "But perfection has a cost."

Luna looked at him. "What cost?"

The First Writer stopped walking. "Choice."

The word echoed through the library. He explained that every time the book changed someone's life, it removed the uncertainty from that person's future. If someone wrote, I want my family to stay together, the book could make it happen.

But it would also change every decision that might have separated them. If someone wrote, I never want to lose anyone again, the book could create a life where nobody left—but it could also remove the freedom to leave. Slowly, Luna understood what Elara had been afraid of. A perfect life was not necessarily a free life.

"You've done this to people," Luna said.

"I gave them what they asked for."

"And then they disappeared."

"They became part of the worlds they created."

Luna looked around the library. "All these books…" "Are the lives they left behind."

For a moment, Luna felt sorry for the people whose stories filled the shelves. They had wanted happiness. They had wanted another chance. They had wanted to fix something. But somewhere along the way, they had lost something more important.

Themselves. Luna looked at the First Writer. "What about Mira?"

His expression changed slightly.

"Why was she erased from my memory?"

"She wasn't erased."

Luna remembered the words from the book.

"She was hidden." He nodded. "By Elara."

“Why?”

“Because Mira discovered something your mother didn't want you to know.”

“What?”

The First Writer looked directly into Luna's eyes.

“Mira discovered what happens when the book chooses someone before they are born.”

Luna's heart stopped. “What does that mean?”

He did not answer immediately. Instead, he looked at the old photograph of Elara that Luna had brought with her.

“Elara used the book before you were born,” he said. “She wrote a future she wanted. She wanted a child who would never know loneliness. A child who would never experience the pain she had experienced.”

Luna stared at him. “My mother wrote about me?”

“Yes.”

“Then… did she create me?”

The First Writer shook his head. “No. But she wrote a path for you.”

Luna felt cold. “That isn't possible.”

“It is.” Her father finally spoke. “That's why Elara was afraid.”

Luna turned toward him. “You knew?”

Her father nodded slowly. “She believed that if Luna followed the path written in the book, she would eventually become another writer.”

Luna looked at the black book. “And Mira?”

The First Writer answered this time. “Mira tried to stop it.”

Luna's eyes widened. “She asked the book to make you forget her because she believed your memories were the only thing keeping you outside the story.”

Luna remembered the sentence. And then she asked the book to make you forget her. Now it finally made sense. Mira had not wanted Luna to forget because she hated her She had wanted Luna to forget because she loved her.

The First Writer walked closer. “Your sister sacrificed her place in your memory so you could have a life that wasn't written for you.”

Luna's eyes filled with tears. “Where is she?”

The First Writer looked toward the deepest part of the library.

“She is where all unfinished stories go.”

“Where?”

He pointed toward a door Luna had never noticed before. A small wooden door stood between two enormous bookshelves. It looked exactly like the door from the garden. The same silver crescent was carved into it. Luna took a step forward.

Her father grabbed her hand. “Don't.”

Luna looked at him. “I have to.”

The First Writer smiled. “You have spent your whole life looking for your mother.”

He looked at the door. “But now you finally have a chance to find your sister.”

Luna slowly reached for the silver key. The door began to glow. Then the First Writer said something that made Luna stop.

“Before you open it, you should know one thing.”

She looked back. “What?”

His eyes were calm. “Your mother didn't disappear because she lost the book.” He paused. “She disappeared because she chose a life without it.” Luna looked at the door again. And for the first time, she wondered whether finding Elara and Mira would mean bringing them back into the world… or opening the door to the world that had taken them.



Even the longest journey
can lead you back to love.

Chapter 15 - A Perfect World

Luna stood in front of the small wooden door, the silver key resting between her fingers. She could hear her father's breathing behind her, but she did not turn around. The First Writer was standing several steps away, watching her quietly. He had told her that Mira was somewhere beyond this door, somewhere unfinished stories went when their writers could no longer return to them. Luna wanted to open it. She wanted to find her sister. She wanted answers about Elara. But something inside her told her that the door was not simply a way to find Mira. It was a choice. She slowly placed the silver key into the lock. The moment she turned it, the entire library disappeared.

Luna opened her eyes and found herself standing in the middle of a beautiful street. The sky was bright blue. Small white clouds moved slowly above the rooftops. Trees lined both sides of the road, and flowers grew everywhere. There were no broken buildings, no traffic, no noise. Everything looked peaceful. Luna turned around, searching for the library, her father, or the First Writer. There was nothing. Only the quiet street stretching in both directions.

She took a few steps forward. A little boy ran past her, laughing. An old woman watered flowers outside her house. Somewhere nearby, someone was playing a piano. It felt normal. Almost too normal. Luna continued walking until she reached a house at the end of the street. She stopped immediately. She knew that house. It was the home she had lived in when she was a child.

The front door opened before she could touch it.

“Luna?”

She froze.

That voice. She had heard it only once in the garden after years of searching.

Her mother.

Luna slowly stepped inside. The house looked exactly as she remembered it, but warmer. The walls were covered with family photographs. There were drawings on the refrigerator. A pair of small yellow shoes sat near the stairs. Luna's heart began beating faster. Then she heard laughter coming from the backyard. She walked toward the sound and stopped at the doorway.

Elara was sitting beneath a tree, smiling. Beside her was Mira, older than the little girl Luna remembered. She was laughing while trying to teach a small dog to sit. When Mira noticed Luna, her face immediately brightened.

"You're finally home." Luna couldn't move. Mira ran toward her. This time, Luna didn't hesitate. She hugged her sister. For a moment, she forgot everything.

The book. The garden. The First Writer. The missing memories.

Everything disappeared. She was simply Luna again, standing beside her family. Elara walked toward them slowly. Her eyes were filled with tears, but she was smiling. "You came back," she whispered. Luna looked at her mother. "I thought I lost you." Elara touched her hair. "You never lost me." Luna looked around the garden. "Where are we?" Elara smiled. "Home." Luna looked at Mira. "Is this real?" Mira laughed. "Why wouldn't it be?" Luna wanted to believe her. More than anything, she wanted to believe her. She had spent years wishing for this exact moment. Her mother was beside her. Her sister was alive. Her family was together. There was no sadness in the house.

No empty chair. No painful memories. No unanswered questions.

That evening, they sat around the dinner table. Elara had made Luna's favorite food. Mira talked about school. Her father laughed at something Mira said. Luna looked around the table and felt something she had almost forgotten.

Peace.

She had never known how much she wanted an ordinary family until she finally had one. Nobody disappeared. Nobody was hiding anything. Nobody was afraid. When dinner ended, Luna helped Mira wash the dishes. Mira splashed a little water toward her, and Luna laughed. It felt so natural that Luna almost forgot that Mira had once been a missing memory. Later, the two sisters sat on the floor of their old bedroom and looked through photographs. There were pictures of birthdays, holidays, school events, and ordinary afternoons. Luna smiled at every one of them.

"This is the life I wanted," she whispered.

Mira looked at her. "Yes."

Luna turned toward her. "How did I forget all this?"

Mira didn't answer. Instead, she looked toward the bedroom door Someone was standing there. The First Writer. Luna immediately stood up.

"What are you doing here?" He smiled. "You asked for your family."

"I didn't ask for this."

“Not with words.”

Luna looked around the room. “What is this place?”

“A life that could have been yours.”

Luna's heart began beating faster. “You made this?”

“I only showed you what the book already knew you wanted.” He walked into the room and looked at the photographs.

“You spent years wishing your mother would return. You wished Mira had never disappeared. You wished your family could be together again. You wished your writing career would succeed. You wished you could wake up one morning and discover that everything painful had never happened.”

Luna looked at him. “How do you know all that?”

He smiled. “The book remembers every wish you have ever made.”

Luna looked at the black book in his hand. “You changed my life.”

“No.”

He shook his head. “I showed you another version of it.”

Luna walked toward the window. Outside, Mira was laughing with Elara in the garden. Her father was fixing the old fence. Everything was peaceful.

“What happens if I stay?”

The First Writer didn't answer immediately.

Instead, he said, "Then this becomes your life."

Luna turned around. "Forever?"

He answer immediately "Yes Forever."

The answer sounded beautiful. And frightening. Luna looked at her mother again. Elara was smiling. But something about that smile felt strange.

Luna walked outside. "Mom?"

Elara looked at her. "Yes?"

"What did you do today?" Elara smiled. "I stayed here."

Luna frowned. "That's all?"

"Yes."

Luna looked at Mira. "What about you?"

Mira smiled. "I played in the garden."

"Every day?"

"Yes."

Luna looked around. Nobody seemed to have plans. Nobody seemed to have worries. Nobody seemed to want anything different. The next morning, Luna noticed something even stranger. Mira woke up at exactly the same time. Elara made exactly the same breakfast. Her father said exactly the same words. The same bird landed on the same branch.

The same song played on the radio. At first, Luna thought it was a coincidence. Then the next day, everything happened again. The same breakfast. The same conversation. The same bird. The same song. The same laughter. The same afternoon walk. The same sunset.

Luna began to feel uncomfortable. One evening, she asked Mira, "Don't you ever get bored?"

Mira looked confused. "Why would I?"

"Don't you want to go somewhere else?"

"We're happy here."

"But don't you want to choose something different?"

Mira smiled. "Why would we need to?"

Luna had no answer. She walked into the living room. Her father was sitting in the same chair. The same book was open in his hands.

"Dad?" He looked up.

"Yes, Luna?"

"Do you remember yesterday?"

He smiled. "Of course."

"What did we have for dinner?"

He paused. Then he answered. "The same thing we're having tonight."

Luna's heart sank. She looked toward the kitchen.

Elara was preparing dinner. The exact same dinner. Again. Luna slowly stepped backward. She understood. This world wasn't changing. It wasn't moving forward. It was repeating. She ran outside.

The First Writer was standing beneath the tree. "You noticed."

Luna looked at him angrily. "They aren't choosing anything."

He remained calm. "They don't need to."

"They're just repeating the same day."

"They are happy."

"No," Luna said. "They're not living."

The First Writer looked at her. "What's the difference?"

Luna stared at him. "Living means choosing what happens next."

For the first time, his smile disappeared. Luna looked toward the house. Her mother was standing at the window. Mira was beside her. Both were smiling. But their smiles looked exactly the same as yesterday. And the day before. And the day before that. Luna suddenly understood the terrible truth.

This wasn't a perfect life.

It was a perfect story.

And someone else was writing every page.

Chapter 16 - The Price of Perfect

Luna stood beneath the tree, staring at the house where everything looked exactly the way she had once dreamed it would. Her mother was inside. Mira was laughing. Her father was sitting at the same chair. The same sunlight fell across the garden. The same bird rested on the same branch. Everything was beautiful, peaceful, and completely wrong. Luna looked at the First Writer.

"How long has this day been happening?" He didn't answer. "How many times?" she asked again. He simply looked at the house. "As many times as necessary." Luna felt a chill. "Necessary for what?" He finally looked at her. "Until you stop wanting to leave." Luna understood then. This world wasn't trying to force her to stay. It was trying to make her want to stay.

She walked back into the house. Her mother immediately smiled. "You're back." Luna looked at her carefully. "Mom, what do you want to do tomorrow?" Elara smiled. "Whatever you want." Luna waited. "No. What do you want?" Elara became quiet for a second. Then she said, "I want us to be together." Luna asked, "But if you could go anywhere, what would you choose?" Elara looked confused.

"Why would I go anywhere?" Luna didn't answer. She went to Mira. "What do you want to become when you grow up?" Mira smiled. "Whatever makes everyone happy." Luna's heart sank. "But what makes you happy?" Mira looked at her for a moment, almost as if she had never heard the question before. Then she said, "I don't know." That answer frightened Luna more than anything else. That night, Luna couldn't sleep. She walked through the house and noticed something she hadn't seen before. There were no clocks.

No calendars. No newspapers. No school bags with unfinished homework.

There were no bills, no broken toys, no dirty dishes left in the sink, no arguments, no tired faces. Nothing ever needed to be repaired because nothing ever truly changed. Luna walked into the kitchen and opened the refrigerator. The same food was inside that she had seen the previous day. She opened a cupboard. The same number of plates. The same cups. Even the flower vase on the table had the same three flowers, in exactly the same position. Luna stepped backward. She suddenly understood that this world did not have a future. It only had a perfect present.

The next morning, Luna decided to test it. She moved the flower vase from the table and placed it near the window. Her mother walked into the room and looked at it. She didn't react. Luna waited. At lunchtime, the vase was back on the table. She moved a chair into another room. A few hours later, it was back where it had always been. She took a family photograph from the wall and placed it inside a drawer. When she returned later, the photograph was hanging on the wall again. Luna stared at it. Nobody had moved those things. The world itself had corrected them. It was as if reality was quietly saying, No. This is how the story goes.

Luna found the First Writer near the garden that evening. “Why can't anything change?” she asked. “Because you are inside a finished story.” “But I'm not finished.” He smiled. “Not yet.” Luna looked at him angrily. “You wrote this world.” “I wrote the rules.” “And everyone inside it?” “They follow them.” Luna shook her head. “My mother wouldn't choose this.” “She chose happiness.” “No,” Luna replied. “She chose freedom.” The First Writer looked at her for a long moment.

“Your mother always believed freedom was more important than happiness. That is why she lost everything.” Luna's voice became quiet. “You mean she chose to leave this world.” “She chose not to live in a world where every answer had already been written.” Luna looked toward the house.

“Then why are they here?” The First Writer answered calmly, “Because this is the version of your family you wanted.” Luna's eyes widened. “You didn't bring them back.” “No.” “They're not really my family.” “They are what your heart remembers them as.” Luna felt angry. “That's cruel.” “Is it?” he asked. “You wanted your mother. You wanted your sister. You wanted the family you lost.

I gave them to you.” Luna looked at the house again. Her mother was laughing. Mira was sitting beneath the tree. For one small moment, Luna wanted to believe him. She wanted to forget everything and stay there forever. She wanted to stop searching. She wanted to stop being afraid. She wanted a life where nobody disappeared.

The First Writer noticed her silence. “You don't have to fight anymore,” he said softly. “You can stay here.” Luna looked at him. “What happens if I stay?” “You wake up every morning with your family. You become the writer you always wanted to be. Your books become successful. People read your stories. You never have to worry about losing anyone again.” Luna's eyes filled with tears. “And what do I have to give you?” He smiled. “Only one thing.” “What?” “Your choice.” Luna stared at him. “I don't understand.” “You don't have to understand yet.”

That night, Luna sat beside Mira beneath the tree. The moon was bright above them. Mira rested her head on Luna's shoulder. “Are you happy?” Mira asked. Luna looked at her. “I think I am.” “Then why do you look sad?” Luna didn't know how to answer. After a moment, she asked, “Mira, if you could change one thing in this world, what would it be?” Mira smiled. “Nothing.” “Nothing?” “Everything is already perfect.” Luna looked at her sister.

“But what if you wanted something different?” Mira looked toward the sky. “Then it wouldn't be perfect anymore.” Luna felt a strange sadness inside her. Mira wasn't choosing peace. She had been written to accept it.

Luna stood up and walked toward the garden gate. She tried to leave the house. The moment she stepped through the gate, the world changed. Suddenly, she was standing in her old apartment. Then she was back in the garden. Then she was in the library. Then she was standing in front of her childhood home.

Different places appeared one after another, like pages being turned too quickly. She saw herself at different ages. She saw herself as a successful writer. She saw herself with Elara. She saw Mira growing older beside her. She saw a version of herself receiving awards on a stage. She saw another version living in a quiet house near the sea. In every life, she was happy.

But in every life, something was missing. In one version, Luna had her mother but no father. In another, she had Mira but had never become a writer. In another, she had become a famous writer but had never met Mira.

In another, she had everything but she didn't remember the life she had before. Luna watched the different versions of herself and finally understood what the First Writer was offering.

Not one perfect life. Every possible perfect life. She could choose any one of them. The First Writer appeared beside her.

"You see?" he said. "You don't have to accept pain. You can choose the version where everything works."

Luna looked at the different versions of herself.

"What happens to the versions I don't choose?"

"They remain stories."

"And the people in them?"

“They remain part of those stories.”

Luna looked at him. “So even you don't know which version is real.”

He smiled. “Reality is whatever you choose to believe.”

Luna looked at the lives around her again. For the first time, she wasn't tempted by how beautiful they were. She was frightened by how easily she could disappear into them. She thought about Mira. She thought about Elara. She thought about all the previous writers whose lives were now trapped inside books. Then she remembered something her mother had once said.

“A life doesn't become yours because it is perfect. It becomes yours because you chose it.”

Luna closed her eyes. When she opened them, the perfect world was gone. She was standing in a dark room. In front of her was a single wooden table. On the table lay the black book. Beside it was a pen. And behind the table stood the First Writer. This time, there was no smile on his face.

“You understand now,” he said.

Luna looked at the final blank page. “What do you want me to write?”

He placed the pen in front of her. “Whatever you want.”

Luna reached toward it. Then stopped. Because for the first time, she realized that the most dangerous thing the book could give her was not sadness.

It was a life where she never had to choose anything again.

Chapter 17 - Elara's Choice

Luna stood in front of the black book without touching it. The pen lay quietly beside the final blank page, waiting for her hand. The First Writer stood across the table, watching her with the patience of someone who had already seen this moment happen many times before. Luna looked at the book and then at him. "You said my mother chose a life without the book," she said.

"What does that really mean?" For the first time, the First Writer did not answer immediately. He walked toward the window of the dark room and looked outside. There was nothing beyond the glass except a deep, endless darkness. "Your mother discovered the truth before you were born," he finally said. "She learned that the book could give her almost anything she wanted. She could change the past, protect the people she loved, and create a future without pain." Luna waited. "And she wanted that?" "At first," he said. "More than anything."

Luna's heart tightened. She imagined Elara as a young woman, sitting alone with the black book in front of her, believing she could finally fix every painful part of her life. "What did she write?" Luna asked. The First Writer turned toward her. "She wrote about you." Luna froze. "Me?" He nodded. "Before you were born, your mother was afraid of the world you would enter.

She had already seen enough sadness to know that life could hurt people in ways they never expected. She wanted to make sure you would never grow up feeling alone." Luna looked down at the blank page. "So she wanted to write a perfect life for me." "Yes." "Then why didn't she?" The First Writer's expression became strangely quiet.

"Because she realized something before it was too late."

He told Luna that Elara had once written a simple sentence in the book: “Let my daughter never know loneliness.” The sentence appeared exactly as she had written it, and the book began changing things around her. People who might have left Elara stayed. Doors that might have closed remained open. Events that could have caused pain slowly changed. At first, Elara was happy.

She believed the book had given her what she wanted. But then she noticed something small. Luna had not even been born yet, but the world was already choosing things for her. Elara realized that if she continued, Luna would grow up inside a life written before she ever had the chance to make her own choices. Elara could protect Luna from sadness, but she could also take away Luna's freedom to face life for herself.

Luna looked at the First Writer. “So she stopped.” “Yes.” “She erased what she wrote?” “She tried.” “And what happened?” He looked at the black book. “The book doesn't like unfinished stories.” Luna slowly understood. Elara had begun a story about Luna, but she refused to finish it. She chose to leave the book behind instead. “She wanted a life without the book,” Luna whispered. “Exactly.” The First Writer's voice became softer. “Your mother chose an ordinary life. A life where you could be happy sometimes and sad sometimes. A life where people could leave and return. A life where you could make mistakes and learn from them. She chose a life that belonged to you, not to the book.”

Luna's eyes filled with tears. “Then why did she disappear?” The First Writer looked at her. “Because the book gave her exactly what she chose.” Luna frowned. “What does that mean?” “Elara wanted a life completely outside the book's story. So the book separated her from the world it controlled.” Luna looked confused. “You mean she went to the world without the book?” He nodded. “A place where the book could no longer write her life.” Luna remembered the garden. The strange place where she had seen her mother. The place that felt both real and unreal.

“The garden…” she whispered. “Was that where she went?” “Part of it.” The First Writer looked toward the darkness. “The garden is a place between stories. It is where people who refuse the book can exist without being rewritten.”

Luna suddenly remembered Elara's face when they had met there. The fear in her eyes. The words she had spoken. You shouldn't have come here. At the time, Luna had thought her mother was afraid for herself. Now she understood.

Elara had been afraid for Luna. “She knew I would come looking for her,” Luna said.

“Yes.”

“And she didn't want me to.”

“No.”

“Because she wanted me to live my own life.”

The First Writer nodded. Luna wiped her tears. “Then why didn't she come back?” He looked at her carefully. “Because coming back would mean allowing the book to find her again.”

Luna became silent. She had spent years believing her mother had abandoned her. She had wondered whether Elara had chosen to leave. She had wondered whether she had not loved her enough to stay. But now she understood that maybe the opposite was true. Elara had loved her enough to leave her own perfect world behind.

Luna looked at the First Writer. “And Mira?”

His expression changed.

“Mira was different.”

“How?”

“Mira discovered what Elara had done. She understood that the book was still connected to your future. She became afraid that one day you would find it.”

Luna remembered the words from her childhood memory. If she remembers me, he'll find her. Her heart sank.

“So Mira wanted me to forget her.”

“Yes.”

“Because she wanted to protect me.”

The First Writer did not answer directly. Instead, he said, “Sometimes protecting someone means allowing them to hate you for leaving.” Luna looked away.

She suddenly remembered the little yellow ribbon. Mira laughing beneath the tree. Mira holding her hand. Mira asking the book to make Luna forget her. It no longer felt like betrayal.

It felt like goodbye.

“But if Mira wanted to protect me,” Luna asked, “why did she stay near the book?”

The First Writer looked at her.

“Because someone had to keep it from finding you.”

Luna's eyes widened. “Mira stayed?”

“Yes.”

“Where?”

The First Writer pointed toward the black book. “Inside the story.”

Luna felt as if the room had suddenly become colder. “Mira is trapped inside the book?”

“Not trapped,” he said. “Waiting.”

“Waiting for what?”

“For you.”

Luna stared at him. The First Writer slowly closed the book.

“She knew that one day you would find it again. She knew you would remember her. And she knew that when you finally came, you would have to make the same choice your mother once made.”

Luna looked at the pen. “What choice?”

He answered quietly.

“Whether to write the life you want… or live the life that is yours.”

Luna looked at the blank page again. Then she heard something. A soft sound. Almost like someone whispering her name.

“Luna…”

She turned around. Nobody was there. The voice came again.

“Luna…” She looked at the black book. The pages began turning by themselves. One page. Then another. Then another. Until they stopped.

A small handwriting appeared on the page. Luna knew it immediately. It was the same handwriting from the childhood note. Mira's handwriting. Only three words were written. Don't trust him. Luna looked up at the First Writer. He was gone. The room was empty. The pen was still on the table. And beneath Mira's message, another sentence slowly appeared.

He is not the one who has been waiting for you.



Chapter 18 - The First Writer's Offer

Luna stared at the words on the page until they slowly disappeared. He is not the one who has been waiting for you. The sentence stayed inside her mind even after the ink vanished. She looked around the room, expecting the First Writer to return, but there was no one there. The door was closed. The windows were dark. Even the strange light that had been surrounding the black book was gone.

Luna reached for the book, but before her fingers touched it, a soft sound came from behind her. “You should listen to her.” Luna turned quickly. The First Writer was standing near the window. He looked completely calm, as if he had never left. Luna stepped backward. “You disappeared.” “I wanted to give you a moment to think.” “About what?” He looked at the book. “About whether you trust me.” Luna remembered Mira's warning. “I don't.” The First Writer nodded slowly. “Good.” Luna frowned. “Good?” “You shouldn't trust anyone simply because they tell you something. Not even me. Not even the book. Not even your memories.” His voice was quiet, almost gentle. “But you should listen before you decide.”

Luna looked at the black book again. “Mira told me not to trust you.” “Yes.” “Why?” “Because Mira has her own reasons.” “Then tell me the truth.” The First Writer walked toward the table and sat down. He did not touch the book. “Your mother chose a life without the book. Mira chose to disappear from your memories.

And now you have found the book. You think these things happened separately. They didn't.” Luna sat across from him. “Then tell me how they are connected.” He looked at her for a long moment. “Everything began with one simple wish.” He opened the book to a page Luna had never seen before.

There was an old sentence written in Elara's handwriting. I want my daughter to have a life where she never feels alone. Luna touched the page carefully. “That's what Mom wrote.” “Yes.” “But she stopped.” “She did.” “Then why does the book still have this?” “Because a wish can be erased from a page,” he said, “but that doesn't mean its consequences disappear.”

Luna lowered her hand. “What consequences?” The First Writer turned another page. Luna saw images appearing across the paper. She saw herself as a child. She saw Mira beside her. She saw Elara watching them. Then the pictures changed. She saw herself growing up without Mira. She saw herself sitting alone at a desk. She saw herself becoming a writer. She saw the black book appearing in her apartment.

“These are possible versions of your life,” the First Writer said. “Some were changed by the book. Some were never allowed to happen.” Luna watched another image appear. She saw herself living with Elara and Mira in a bright house. They were laughing around a dinner table. “That life…” she whispered. “Could have been yours.” Luna looked at him. “But it isn't.” “No.” “Why are you showing me this?” He closed the book. “Because I want you to understand that I am not asking you to destroy your life. I am offering you the chance to choose which life you want.”

Luna stood up immediately. “Choose?” “Yes.” “You mean I can choose a different reality?” “You can.” “Can I bring Mira back?” “Yes.” “Can I bring my mother back?” “Yes.” “Can I change everything that happened?” “Yes.” Luna stared at him. The answers came too easily. There was no hesitation. No warning. No complicated explanation. Just one word every time. Yes. That frightened her more than a no would have. “What do you want in return?” she asked.

The First Writer smiled faintly. “Nothing you cannot give.” Luna narrowed her eyes. “That's not an answer.” “Then let me be clear.” He placed the pen on the table. “I want you to write.” Luna looked at the pen. “Write what?” “Your life.”

For a moment, Luna said nothing. “That's all?” “That's all.” “I write one thing and you make it real?” “If the book accepts it.” Luna looked at the black cover. “And if it doesn't?” “Then nothing changes.” Luna slowly sat down again. “What would happen if I wrote that Mira should come back?” “She would.” “If I wrote that Mom should come back?” “She would.” “If I wrote that none of this ever happened?” The First Writer looked directly at her.

“Then you would wake up in a life where you never lost them.” Luna's heart began beating faster. She imagined waking up tomorrow morning and finding Elara in the kitchen. She imagined Mira walking into her room and complaining that Luna had taken too long to get ready. She imagined her father laughing at the breakfast table. She imagined going back to school, growing up with Mira, having ordinary arguments, birthdays, holidays, and family photographs that had never been erased. She imagined a life without years of questions.

For the first time, the offer did not sound frightening.

It sounded kind.

The First Writer seemed to understand what she was thinking. “You don't have to be strong all the time, Luna.” His voice became softer. “You don't have to keep searching for answers. You don't have to carry the pain your mother left behind. You don't have to wonder where Mira is. You don't have to wake up every morning wondering what happened to your family.” Luna looked down. “I know.” “Then why keep fighting?” She didn't answer.

“You have already lost enough,” he continued. “Why should you lose more just because you believe suffering makes a life real?” Luna looked at him. “Are you saying sadness is necessary?” “No.” He shook his head. “I'm saying it doesn't have to be.”

Luna closed her eyes. The words reached the part of her that had been tired for years. She had wanted answers, but maybe what she really wanted was her family. She had wanted to understand her mother's disappearance, but maybe she would be happier if she never had to think about it again. She had wanted Mira back, but maybe she didn't care how it happened. For a few seconds, the room around her became quiet. She could almost hear Mira laughing.

She could almost hear Elara calling her name. She could almost feel her mother's hand on her hair. Luna opened her eyes. “If I accept, will I remember this place?” “No.” “Will I remember the book?” “No.” “Will I remember you?” “No.” “Then how will I know that I chose anything?” The First Writer smiled. “You won't.”

That answer made Luna uncomfortable.

She stood up and walked toward the window. Outside was the same endless darkness. “If I don't remember choosing it, then is it really my choice?” The First Writer didn't answer. Luna turned toward him. “You said you wanted me to choose.” “I do.” “But if you make me forget the choice, then you are deciding my life for me.” His face remained calm. “Only if you believe that remembering is what makes a choice real.” Luna looked at him for a long moment. “It does.” He smiled slightly. “Then perhaps you are not ready yet.”

He waved his hand toward the darkness.

The room changed.

Luna suddenly found herself standing in a small house near the sea. Waves moved gently beyond the windows. On the wall were framed photographs of her books. Her name was printed on every cover. She was a successful writer.

People knew her stories. Her desk was filled with letters from readers. She walked through the house and found Elara in the kitchen. Her mother looked exactly as Luna remembered her. “You're home,” Elara said. Luna's eyes filled with tears. “Mom…” Elara smiled. “Why are you crying?” Luna hugged her. “I missed you.” Elara laughed softly. “I haven't gone anywhere.” Luna pulled away and looked at her face. Everything felt real. Too real.

Then Mira walked through the door.

She was older now.

She smiled at Luna.

“Did you finish your book?”

Luna laughed through her tears.

“Yes.”

They sat together that evening, talking about ordinary things. Mira told Luna about her day. Elara complained about the weather. They argued about what to eat for dinner. Luna listened to them and realized that this was exactly what she had wanted all her life.

No mystery... No magic... No missing people... No fear...

Just home. The First Writer's voice came from behind her.

“You can have this.”

Luna turned. He was standing near the doorway.

“You can keep your mother,” he said. “You can keep Mira. You can keep your family. You can become the writer you always wanted to be. You can even change the painful parts of your past so they never happened.”

Luna looked at the people she loved.

“What happens to the life I have now?”

He answered simply. “It becomes another story.”

Luna looked at Mira. “And what happens to the real Mira?”

The First Writer paused. “You won't need to know.”

That sentence broke the beauty of the room. Luna looked around again. Her mother's smile. Mira's laughter. Her beautiful house. Her successful books. Everything she had wanted. But suddenly, she noticed something. Mira was sitting in the exact same position she had been sitting in a few minutes earlier.

Elara was holding the same cup. The clock on the wall had not moved. The waves outside repeated the same movement. Luna's smile disappeared. She looked at the First Writer.

“This isn't real.”

“It is real enough.”

“No.”

She shook her head. “It looks like my life, but it isn't mine.”

The First Writer remained silent.

Luna looked at Mira again. She wanted to believe. She really did. But she couldn't forget the feeling she had in the perfect world. Everything was beautiful because nothing was allowed to change.

Luna walked back toward the First Writer. "Why me?"

He looked at her. "Because the book waited for you."

"But why?"

He smiled. "That is the question you should be asking."

Luna looked at the black book that had appeared on the table again. The final page was still blank. The pen lay beside it. The First Writer pushed the pen toward her.

"You don't have to decide tonight."

Luna stared at the pen. "Then when?"

"When you are ready to stop asking what you should choose…"

He paused. "And start asking what you truly want."

The room slowly faded. The perfect house disappeared. Elara disappeared. Mira disappeared. The sea disappeared. Luna found herself back in the dark room. The First Writer was standing in front of her. The black book was open.

The final page was waiting.

Luna picked up the pen. Her hand trembled. She could write one sentence.

One sentence could bring her mother back. One sentence could bring Mira back. One sentence could erase every painful memory. One sentence could give her the life she had always wanted. The First Writer watched silently.

Luna lowered the pen toward the page. Then she stopped. Because somewhere deep inside the book, she heard a familiar voice. It's Mira. Not loud. Not frightened. Just one quiet whisper.

"Luna… don't let someone else write your life."

Luna slowly lifted her eyes. The First Writer was still smiling. But this time, Luna noticed something she had never noticed before. He wasn't waiting for her to write.

He was waiting for her to give up.



Chapter 19 - The Life Luna Wanted

Luna slowly lowered the pen. Her fingers were still wrapped around it, but she no longer felt the need to write. The final page of the black book remained completely blank. The First Writer stood on the other side of the table, watching her without saying a word. For the first time, Luna could see what he had been doing all along. He had never needed to force her. He had never needed to threaten her.

He simply showed her everything she had ever wanted and waited for her to choose it. Luna placed the pen on the table. "You knew I would hesitate," she said. The First Writer gave a small smile. "I knew you would understand eventually." Luna looked at the book. "Understand what?" He answered quietly, "That the hardest thing to give up is not something you hate. It is something you love." Luna looked away. She knew exactly what he meant. If he had offered her a world filled with fear or pain, she would have refused immediately. But he had offered her Elara. He had offered her Mira. He had offered her the childhood she had lost, the family she had missed, and the future she had always imagined. Saying no to that was much harder than saying no to the book itself.

The room around Luna slowly changed again. The darkness disappeared, and she found herself standing in a long hallway filled with doors. Every door was different. Some were small and white. Some were tall and wooden. Some looked old, while others looked completely new. There were hundreds of them, perhaps thousands. Luna looked at the First Writer. "Where are we?" He walked past her and stopped beside the first door. "Every door is a life you could have lived."

Luna looked at the door. "Every door?" "Every choice creates a different path. The book can show you those paths." He opened the first door. Luna saw herself as a little girl running through a garden with Mira. She was laughing.

Elara was watching them. Luna closed the door. The First Writer opened another. This time, Luna saw herself as a teenager sitting beside her mother, talking about books. In another life, Luna saw herself growing up with Mira and becoming a teacher. In another, she was travelling around the world. In another, she had never become a writer at all. Each life looked different, but every one of them contained something Luna had once wished for.

Then he opened a door that made Luna stop breathing. Inside was a small bedroom. A little girl was sitting on the floor. She was holding a book and drawing something with a pencil. Luna recognized herself. She was younger, perhaps seven or eight years old. Mira was sitting beside her.

The two girls were drawing together. Elara was standing behind them.

Luna stepped closer to the doorway. "This is my childhood."

"One version of it," the First Writer said. Luna watched the younger version of herself laugh as Mira showed her a drawing. She could almost remember the moment. She could almost feel the warmth of the room. She looked at Elara. Her mother was smiling.

There was no sadness in her face. No fear. No disappearance waiting in the future. Luna wanted to step inside. "Can I stay here?" she asked. "You can do more than stay." He looked at her. "You can make this your life." Luna turned toward him. "How?" "Write it."

Luna looked at the little girl again. "If I write this life, what happens to the Luna who is already living it?" The First Writer answered calmly, "Nothing. She becomes you." Luna frowned. "That doesn't make sense." "The book doesn't move you into another life.

It rewrites the life you already have." Luna's expression changed.

“So everyone around me would remember this version?” “Yes.” “My father?” “Yes.” “Mira?” “Yes.” “Mom?” “Yes.” Luna stared at him. “And none of them would know that anything was changed?” “They wouldn't need to.” Luna slowly stepped away from the door.

“So I'd be the only one who knew.” “At first.” “And then?”

“Eventually, even you would forget.”

Luna looked frightened. “Forget what?” “This life. The old life. The book. Everything.” He spoke as though he were explaining something ordinary. “You would simply wake up one day and believe that this has always been your life.”

Luna looked back at the little girl inside the room.

She imagined waking up in that world and believing Mira had always been beside her. She imagined having memories of birthdays with her sister that had never happened. Memories of her mother helping with schoolwork. Memories of family trips. Memories of ordinary arguments and ordinary happiness. It was tempting. More than tempting.

It was the kind of temptation that made her heart hurt.

The First Writer opened another door.

This time, Luna saw herself older, sitting at a desk in a beautiful room. Books were stacked everywhere. Her name was printed on the covers. A large window looked out over a city full of lights. Luna was writing the final page of a novel.

Her mother was sitting nearby, reading another book. Mira was on the sofa, laughing at something on her phone. Her father brought tea into the room. It looked peaceful. Successful. Complete. Luna stared at the scene.

“My writing career…” she whispered. “You always wanted to become a writer whose stories reached people,” the First Writer said. “You could have that too.” Luna watched the other version of herself smile at her family. She looked happy. There was no struggle in her face. No fear that she would fail. No empty pages. No doubt about her future. Luna felt something inside her pull toward that life.

“You could wake up every morning knowing exactly where your life is going,” the First Writer said. “You would never have to wonder whether your dreams will come true.” Luna looked at him. “But if you write it for me, they're not really my dreams anymore.” He remained silent. Luna turned back to the door. “That Luna didn't choose any of this.” “Neither did the people in your current life choose everything that happened to them.” “That's different.” “Is it?” he asked. “People are always shaped by things they never chose. Their families. Their circumstances. Their losses. Their opportunities. I simply remove the uncertainty.”

Luna shook her head. “You remove the freedom.”

The First Writer smiled slightly. “Freedom is often another word for uncertainty.”

Luna didn't answer. He opened another door. This time, she saw Mira as an adult. She was standing in a sunny garden, holding a little girl's hand. The child ran toward Luna and hugged her. “Aunt Luna!” Luna froze. She looked at Mira. Her sister smiled. “You came late again.” Luna laughed. She had never imagined herself as an aunt.

She had never imagined Mira growing up, getting older, building a life of her own. She had lost all those possibilities before she even knew they existed. She looked at Mira's face and felt tears forming in her eyes. “She gets to grow up here?” Luna asked. “Yes.” “And Mom?” “She grows old.” “And Dad?” “He stays with you.” Luna closed her eyes.

This was the life she wanted. Not because it was perfect. Because it gave her back everything she had lost. The First Writer stood beside her. “You can have it.” Luna opened her eyes. “Everything?” “Everything.” “No more searching?” “No more searching.” “No more fear?” “No more fear.” “No more wondering whether Mira is alive?” “Never again.” “And I can write?” “You can write every day.” Luna looked at him. “Then why does this feel wrong?”

The First Writer's expression became serious. “Because you know the truth.”

Luna looked at the door. “What truth?”

“That every beautiful thing you see here comes with a price.”

She turned toward him. “What price?”

He didn't answer. Instead, he opened one final door. There was nothing inside. No family... No house... No garden... No books...

Only Luna. She was standing alone in a completely empty room. She looked older. Tired. But she was smiling. Luna stared at the other version of herself.

“What life is that?”

The First Writer answered, “The life you would have if you refused every version I offered.”

Luna looked surprised.

“She has nothing.”

“She has herself.”

Luna watched the other Luna sit on the floor and open a blank notebook. She began writing. There was no family around her. No magical book. No perfect future. She didn't know what tomorrow would bring. She didn't know whether her dreams would come true. She didn't know whether everyone she loved would stay. But she kept writing anyway.

Luna stared at her. “Is she happy?”

The First Writer shook his head. “Sometimes.”

“Is she sad?” “Sometimes.”

“Is she successful?” “Sometimes.”

“Does she lose people?” “Yes.”

Luna swallowed. “Does she find them again?” “Sometimes.”

“Then what's special about her?”

The First Writer looked directly at Luna. “Nothing.”

Luna frowned. Then he continued. “And everything.” The words stayed with her.

That version of Luna had no perfect ending waiting for her. She had no guarantee. She had no promise that everything would work out. But every morning, she would wake up and decide what to do next. Every page she wrote would belong to her.

Luna slowly understood why the First Writer had shown her that door.

It wasn't another temptation.

It was the truth. A life didn't become valuable because everything went right. It became valuable because it was lived. Luna turned away from the doors. “I don't want these lives.”

The First Writer looked at her. “Are you sure?”

“No.”

He raised an eyebrow. Luna took a breath. “I'm not sure about anything anymore. I don't know if I'll find Mira. I don't know if I'll see my mother again. I don't know what will happen to my writing. I don't even know what my life will look like next year.”

She looked at the endless hallway. “But I want to find out myself.”

The First Writer's face became unreadable. “You would choose uncertainty?”

“Yes.”

“You would choose the possibility of losing them again?”

Luna's eyes filled with tears. “I would rather lose something real than keep something that was never mine.”

The hallway became silent. One by one, the doors began closing. The perfect childhood disappeared. The successful writer disappeared. The family by the sea disappeared. The future with Mira disappeared. The life where Luna never felt lonely disappeared. Soon, only one door remained. It was plain.

Old. And completely blank.

Luna walked toward it.

“What is behind this door?” she asked.

The First Writer didn't answer. Luna opened it herself. There was no perfect family waiting for her. No magical garden... No successful future... No promise...

Only a small desk. A blank notebook. And a window showing an ordinary morning. Luna smiled.

“This is enough.” Behind her, the First Writer quietly said:

“Then you have finally reached the last choice.”

Luna turned around. He was holding the black book. He opened it to the final page. The page was still blank. He placed the pen beside it.

“Write one sentence,” he said. “One sentence is all it takes.”

Luna looked at the page. She knew what she could write. She could bring Mira back. She could bring Elara back. She could rewrite her childhood. She could make herself successful. She could erase every painful moment. She could make everything perfect. But now she understood the real question.

It wasn't:

“What life do I want?”

It was:

“Who gets to decide what my life becomes?”

Luna slowly reached for the pen.

The First Writer watched her. And this time, Luna wasn't afraid of what she might write. She was afraid of what would happen if she didn't.



Chapter 20 - The Last Page

The room became completely silent. Luna stood in front of the small desk, looking at the black book. The final page was open in front of her, clean and white, as if nothing had ever been written on it. The pen rested beside the book. She had seen hundreds of pages since the day she first found it, but somehow this one felt different. It did not feel like an ordinary blank page.

It felt as though the entire book had been waiting for this moment. Luna slowly sat down. Her fingers moved toward the pen, but before she could pick it up, the First Writer spoke. “This is your last chance.” Luna looked at him. “Last chance for what?” He stepped closer to the table. “To change everything.” His voice was calm, almost kind. “One sentence, Luna. That's all you need.”

Luna looked at the blank page. “And whatever I write becomes real?” “If the book accepts it.” “And if I write something about my mother?” “She can return.” “Mira?” “She can return.” “My childhood?” “It can change.” Luna swallowed. “My future?” “It can become whatever you want.”

Luna stared at the page. The possibilities began moving through her mind like flashes of light. She could write that Elara had never disappeared. She could write that Mira had never been erased from her memory. She could write that her family had stayed together. She could write that she had become a successful writer without ever struggling. She could write that nobody she loved would ever leave her again.

She could even write that the black book had never existed. The thought made her hand tremble. If one sentence could erase everything, why was she still hesitating? Wasn't this what she had wanted from the beginning? She had searched for her mother. She had searched for Mira. She had wanted answers.

She had wanted to undo the past. Now the book was offering her exactly that. Luna closed her eyes and imagined opening her apartment door tomorrow morning and seeing Elara standing there. She imagined Mira calling her name from the hallway. She imagined sitting around the dinner table with her family. She imagined growing old without ever wondering what happened to them. For a few seconds, she almost smiled.

Then she opened her eyes. The room was still empty.

No mother... No sister... No father...

Only the book.

Luna looked at the First Writer. “Why are you giving me this choice?” He answered, “Because you are finally ready.” “Ready for what?” “To understand what the book was created for.” Luna frowned. “You said it grants wishes.” “That is what people believe.” “Then what does it really do?” The First Writer walked toward the window.

“It gives people the power to write the life they think they want.” Luna waited. “And then?” “Then it asks them what they are willing to give up for it.” Luna looked down at the book. “What did the previous writers give up?” The First Writer's expression changed slightly. “Some gave up their memories. Some gave up their relationships.

Some gave up their ability to choose. Some simply forgot who they were before they found the book.” Luna's eyes widened. “And Elara?” He was silent for a moment. “Your mother gave up the life she could have had.” Luna's heart tightened. “She gave it up for me?” “She gave it up because she believed your life should belong to you.”

Luna looked at the final page again. “And Mira?” The First Writer didn't answer immediately. “Mira gave up something too.”

“What?” “The one thing she wanted most.” Luna's voice became quiet. “What was that?” He looked directly at her. “To be remembered by you.” Luna froze. The words hurt more than she expected. Mira had wanted Luna to remember her, but she had chosen to let Luna forget her.

She had accepted being forgotten because she believed it would keep Luna safe. Luna looked away as tears filled her eyes. “Then why did the book bring me here?” she asked. “Why did it wait for me?” The First Writer smiled faintly. “Because every person who finds the book reaches a moment when they must choose between a life that is perfect and a life that is theirs.” Luna slowly understood. The book wasn't simply testing what she wanted. It was testing whether she was willing to let someone else decide it for her.

The First Writer pushed the pen closer. “You don't have to think about everyone else anymore.” Luna looked at him. “What do you mean?” “Think about yourself.” He pointed toward the page. “Write that you want your mother back. Write that you want Mira back. Write that you want success. Write that you want happiness.

You have spent your entire life carrying other people's choices. Your mother's choice. Mira's choice. Your father's silence. The world's expectations. Why shouldn't you finally choose something for yourself?” Luna listened carefully. His words sounded reasonable. They sounded like freedom. Maybe choosing what she wanted wasn't selfish. Maybe she deserved to be happy. Maybe there was nothing wrong with asking the book to fix the things that had hurt her. She picked up the pen.

The tip touched the paper. Nothing happened. Luna took a slow breath. She began writing the first word. Then she stopped. She looked at the sentence forming in her mind. I want...

She couldn't continue. She thought about the perfect world. She remembered Mira saying, Everything is already perfect.

She remembered moving the flower vase and finding it back in the same place. She remembered asking her mother what she wanted, only to hear that she wanted whatever Luna wanted. She remembered seeing the different versions of herself. Every life had been beautiful.

But none of them had been free. Luna placed the pen down.

The First Writer watched her. "What's wrong?"

Luna looked at him. "I don't know what I want."

"You just spent an entire day looking at the lives you wanted."

"No," she said softly. "I saw the lives I used to think I wanted."

The First Writer's expression became serious.

Luna continued, "I wanted my mother back. I wanted Mira back. I wanted to become successful. I wanted a perfect childhood. I wanted a future where nobody left me. But now I understand something."

"What?"

"If I write all of that, I'll never know what my real life could have become."

The First Writer stepped closer.

"Perhaps your real life would hurt you."

"It might."

"You might lose people again."

“I might.”

“You might fail.”

“Yes.”

“You might never become the writer you dream of becoming.”

Luna looked at the blank page.

“Yes.”

“You might regret your choices.”

She nodded.

“Yes.”

The First Writer looked almost disappointed. “And you're willing to accept all of that?”

Luna took a long breath. “I don't want to accept it. But I want the choice to face it myself.”

The First Writer became completely silent. Luna looked at the book. “Tell me something honestly.”

“What?”

“Can I write nothing?”

For the first time, the First Writer's calm expression disappeared. Luna noticed it.

She stood up. “Can I choose not to choose what you want me to choose?”

The room seemed to become colder. The pages of the book began turning by themselves. Slowly at first. Then faster. The sound filled the room. Luna stepped backward.

The First Writer looked at the book. “You don't understand what you're asking.”

“Then tell me.”

“You cannot leave the final page blank.”

“Why?”

“Because someone must write the ending.”

Luna looked at him.

“No.”

The word came out quietly. The First Writer stared at her. Luna repeated it.

“No one has to write my ending.” The lights in the room flickered. The black book began shaking on the table. The First Writer's voice became stronger.

“Every story needs an ending.”

“Maybe.”

Luna walked toward the table. “But my life isn't your story.” The book suddenly slammed shut. Luna jumped. The First Writer stepped forward.

“Then write your own.”

Luna looked at the closed book.

“What if I don't know the ending?”

“Then you will live without knowing.”

She looked at him. “And that's what scares you?”

He didn't answer. Luna slowly understood. The First Writer wasn't afraid of what she would write. He was afraid that she would refuse to write at all. Because if she refused, he couldn't control what came next. Luna picked up the pen again. The First Writer watched closely. She opened the book. The final page was blank. She held the pen above it. For a moment, she thought about writing Mira. Then Elara. Then home. Then happiness. But she stopped herself.

“What happens if I write nothing?” she asked again.

This time, the First Writer answered. “The story becomes unfinished.”

Luna looked at the blank page. “And what happens to an unfinished story?”

He looked at her. “It waits.” Luna's heart skipped. The words reminded her of the sentence she had seen on the very first page.

“**I have been waiting for you.**”

She finally understood that the book had never been waiting for someone to write the perfect ending. It had been waiting for someone who would dare to leave the ending unwritten. Luna lowered the pen. She didn't write her mother's return. She didn't write Mira's return.

She didn't write success. She didn't write happiness. She didn't write away her pain. Instead, she placed the pen beside the book.

"I choose nothing." The First Writer stared at her. For several seconds, nothing happened. Then a single crack appeared across the black cover. Luna stepped back. Another crack appeared. The pages began turning rapidly. The room shook. The First Writer looked at the book with something Luna had never seen in his eyes before.

Fear. Luna finally understood. The final page had never been asking her to write an ending. It had been asking her to surrender her freedom. And she had just refused. The black book opened by itself. The blank final page slowly turned dark.

Then one sentence appeared. Not written by Luna. Not written by the First Writer. It appeared as though the book itself had written it. Then choose what happens next. Luna stared at the words. The First Writer stepped backward. And somewhere far away, behind the walls of the story, Luna heard a familiar voice. Mira. This time, she wasn't whispering. She was calling her name.

"Luna!"

Luna turned toward the sound.

The First Writer looked frightened. And for the first time since Luna had found the book, he was no longer in control.

Chapter 21 - The Choice

The moment Luna heard Mira call her name, the room seemed to stop breathing. The black book was still open on the table, its pages moving without any wind, while thin cracks continued to spread across its dark cover. The First Writer stood several steps away, staring at the book as though he had never seen it behave this way before. Luna looked toward the sound.

"Mira?" Her voice was small, but the room answered with a faint echo. "Luna…" This time the voice came from somewhere beyond the walls. Luna took one step forward. The First Writer immediately said, "Don't." Luna stopped and looked at him. There was something different in his voice now. It wasn't calm anymore.

It wasn't patient. It was afraid. "Why?" she asked. He didn't answer. Luna took another step. "Where is she?" "You don't understand what you're doing." "Then explain it." The First Writer looked at the black book. "The book has never done this before." Luna slowly walked toward the table. "Maybe because nobody ever refused it."

The pages suddenly stopped turning. The final page was still visible. The sentence remained there: Then choose what happens next. Luna stared at it. "What does that mean?" she asked. The First Writer came closer, but he didn't touch the book. "It means the book has accepted your choice." Luna frowned. "I didn't choose anything."

"Exactly." She looked confused. "Then why did it accept it?" He looked at her for a long moment. "Because that was the choice it was waiting for." Luna's heart began beating faster. She remembered the first day she had opened the book. The blank page. The strange sentence. The words that had appeared without her writing them.

I have been waiting for you.

All this time, she had thought the book was waiting for someone powerful enough to use it. She had thought it was searching for someone who could write the perfect story. But now she wondered whether she had misunderstood it from the beginning. “It wasn't waiting for someone to control it,” she whispered. “No,” the First Writer said. “It was waiting for someone who would refuse to.”

Luna looked at him. “Then why did it give me all those powers?” “Because it needed to know what you would do with them.” Luna remembered every small change she had made. Every wish. Every altered memory. Every time she had been excited by the idea that she could fix something. The book had never stopped her. It had allowed her to continue. It had shown her how easy it was to change one thing and then another until she no longer knew where her real life ended and the rewritten life began.

Luna slowly understood the deeper truth. “The book isn't a wish book.” The First Writer nodded. “No.” “It's a test.” “Yes.” Luna looked at the pages. “A test of what?” He answered quietly, “Whether someone will give up their freedom when they are offered a perfect life.” Luna looked at the doors she had seen earlier. Every perfect childhood. Every perfect family. Every perfect future. Every version of herself that had seemed happier than the real Luna. They had never been simple rewards.

They had been questions. Would you rather have everything you want, or have the freedom to choose what happens next? Luna looked at the First Writer. “And every previous writer failed?” He looked down. “Most of them.” “What happened to them?” “They chose their perfect stories.” Luna's voice became quieter. “And then?” “They stopped writing their own lives. Eventually, they became part of the stories they created.” Luna remembered the strange places she had seen.

The empty rooms. The repeating days. The people who seemed happy but never changed. They weren't living inside their wishes. They were trapped inside them.

Luna looked at him carefully. “What about you?” The First Writer remained silent. “You said you created the book. Why?” After a long pause, he finally answered. “Because I believed I could save people from pain.” Luna waited. “I watched people make terrible choices. I watched families break apart. I watched people lose the ones they loved. I watched dreams disappear.

I thought the problem was simple. If people could write their lives before they lived them, they could avoid every mistake.” “So you created the book.” “Yes.” “And you thought a perfect life would make people happy.” “I did.” Luna looked around the room. “But it didn't.” He shook his head. “No.” His voice became quieter. “I eventually realized that people don't only need happiness.

They need the freedom to decide what happiness means to them.” Luna looked at him with surprise. “Then why are you still doing this?” He looked toward the book. “Because I couldn't accept that I was wrong.” The room became silent. Luna suddenly felt something she hadn't expected to feel toward him.

Not fear.

Pity.

The First Writer had spent so long trying to create perfect lives that he had forgotten how to live an uncertain one himself. He had built a world where nobody had to make difficult choices because he was afraid of making his own. Luna looked at him. “You're still trying to prove that you were right.” He didn't deny it.

“If someone chooses the perfect life, then everything I believed was true.” Luna shook her head. “No. It only means they were tired enough to give up.” The First Writer looked at her. “And you aren't tired?” Luna smiled sadly. “I am.” She looked at the black book. “I'm just tired of letting my pain decide for me.”

Suddenly, the floor beneath Luna began to disappear. The dark room cracked like glass. Through the cracks, Luna could see the garden. She saw the old trees. She saw the path where she had first met Elara. She saw a small figure standing near the far end of the garden. Luna's heart stopped. “Mira.” The First Writer stepped toward her. “Don't go.” Luna turned. “Why?” “Because if you leave now, you may never be able to return.” Luna looked at the garden.

“Then I won't return.” She stepped through the opening. The moment her foot touched the garden, the air changed. It smelled like rain and flowers. The trees moved gently in the wind. Everything looked familiar, but this time the garden didn't feel frightening. It felt like a place that had been waiting for her.

Mira was standing beneath the old tree.

She looked exactly as Luna remembered her from the childhood photograph, but there was something different in her eyes now. She looked tired. She looked relieved. And she looked as though she had been waiting for a very long time. Luna walked toward her slowly. “Mira?” Mira smiled. “You remembered.” Luna's eyes filled with tears.

“I never really forgot you, did I?” Mira shook her head. “Not completely.” “Then why did you ask the book to erase you?” Mira looked down. “Because I was scared.” “Of the First Writer?” “Yes.” Luna stepped closer. “You thought if I remembered you, he would find me.” Mira nodded. “I thought I could keep you safe if you forgot me.”

Luna's voice trembled. “You could have told me.” “You were too young.” “You could have waited.” “I did.” Luna looked at her. “How long?” Mira smiled sadly. “Long enough to learn that waiting is harder than being forgotten.”

Luna hugged her sister. Neither of them spoke for a while. When they finally stepped apart, Luna asked, “Did Mom know?” Mira nodded. “She knew what I was trying to do.” “Then why didn't she stop you?” “Because she understood.” Mira looked toward the garden path. “Mom made the same choice once.

She chose to let you live your own life, even though she knew she couldn't protect you from everything.” Luna wiped her tears. “She wanted me to be happy.” Mira smiled. “Yes. But more than that, she wanted you to be free.” Luna looked at the trees. “Where is she now?” Mira didn't answer immediately. Then she pointed toward the far end of the garden.

Elara was standing there. Luna's breath caught. Her mother looked peaceful. Not like the frightened woman Luna had seen before. Not like someone who had disappeared. Just like a mother waiting for her daughter.

Luna walked toward her. “Elara…”

Her mother smiled. “I knew you would come.”

Luna stopped in front of her. “Why didn't you come back?” Elara looked at her with gentle eyes. “Because I wanted you to find your way without me choosing it for you.” Luna shook her head. “I thought you left me.” “I know.” “I thought maybe you didn't love me enough to stay.” Elara's eyes filled with tears. “Luna, leaving you was the hardest choice I ever made.” Luna looked at her. “Then why?” Elara touched Luna's face.

“Because if I had stayed and used the book to protect you, I would have given you a life that belonged to me. I wanted you to have a life that belonged to you.”

Luna finally understood the choice her mother had made. Elara hadn't chosen a perfect life. She had chosen an uncertain one. She had accepted that Luna might feel lonely sometimes. She had accepted that Luna might fail. She had accepted that Luna might be hurt. Not because she didn't care.

Because she trusted Luna enough to believe that she could live through those things.

Luna hugged her mother. “I wanted you to save me.”

Elara held her tightly. “I wanted to.”

“Then why didn't you?”

“Because sometimes loving someone means knowing when not to choose for them.”

Luna closed her eyes. For the first time, she understood why the book had waited for her. It hadn't waited because she was special. It hadn't waited because she was the strongest writer. It hadn't waited because she could create the best world. It had waited because she had spent her whole life trying to rewrite the endings of things she couldn't change.

And now she had finally learned that not every ending needed to be rewritten. Some things needed to be accepted. Some things needed to be remembered. And some things simply needed to be allowed to become whatever they were meant to become. Behind them, the garden began to shake.

The trees moved violently. The sky darkened. The black book appeared in the distance, floating above the ground. The First Writer stood beside it. He looked at Luna one final time. “You have made your choice.” Luna looked at Elara.

Then Mira. Then the book.

“Yes.”

The First Writer lowered his head. “Then the story can no longer be written for you.”

The black book began to close. Page after page disappeared into darkness. The garden started fading. Mira reached for Luna's hand. Elara stood beside them. Luna looked at the world that had held so many secrets for so long.

She was afraid. She didn't know what would happen next. She didn't know whether she would wake up with every memory restored. She didn't know whether her mother and Mira would still be there. She didn't know what her future would look like. But this time, she didn't ask the book for an answer. She simply held her mother's hand. And for the first time in her life, Luna was ready to face a future she had not written.

Because she finally understood something the book had been trying to teach her from the beginning: A perfect life is not the same as a free life. And Luna would rather have a life she could truly call her own.

Chapter 22 - My Life Is Mine

For a few moments, nobody moved. The First Writer's words remained in the air like the final line of a story that had not yet reached its true ending. “Then the story can no longer be written for you.” Luna stood beside Elara and Mira, still holding their hands, while the black book slowly closed in front of them. One page disappeared after another, and with every page that vanished, the garden became quieter. The strange flowers lost their glow.

The trees became pale shadows. Even the sky above them seemed to be fading into a soft grey. Luna watched everything disappear, but she did not try to stop it. She had spent so long trying to change things because she was afraid of losing them. Now, for the first time, she let something disappear without asking the book to bring it back.

Then the black book stopped.

Luna looked at it.

The cover was almost completely closed, but one page remained open. It was the final page. The page the First Writer had asked her to write on. The page that had been waiting for her choice. Luna slowly let go of Mira's hand and walked toward it. Mira took one step forward. “Luna…” Luna turned and gave her a small smile.

“It's okay.” Elara watched her carefully. “You don't have to write anything.” Luna nodded. “I know.” She looked at the blank page. “That's what I finally understand.” The First Writer stood a short distance away, watching silently. He still didn't know what Luna was going to do. Neither did Mira. Neither did Elara. And Luna herself wasn't completely sure.

She reached for the pen.

The same pen that had changed so many lives was lying beside the book. Luna picked it up slowly. It felt strangely ordinary in her hand. She remembered the first time she had held it. Back then, she had believed the pen was a way to fix everything. If something hurt, she could rewrite it. If someone left, she could bring them back. If she didn't like a memory, she could replace it. But now she understood the danger of that power. A life could not be made perfect simply by removing every painful part of it. Pain was not the only thing that made a life real. Mistakes, choices, losses, happiness, surprises, and even uncertainty belonged to a person's story too.

Luna looked at the First Writer. "You wanted me to write one sentence." He slowly nodded. "Yes." "And you said you would make it real." "Yes." Luna looked down at the blank page. "Then I'll write something." The First Writer watched her closely, but there was no fear in his face yet. He still believed she might choose the life he had offered. Maybe he expected her to write about Elara. Maybe he expected her to bring Mira back exactly as she remembered her. Maybe he expected Luna to ask for a perfect future. He waited.

Luna placed the pen on the page.

She thought about Elara. She thought about Mira. She thought about all the people who had disappeared into the book. She thought about the First Writer. And then she thought about herself. Not the Luna who had lost her mother. Not the Luna who had spent years wondering what happened. Not the Luna who wanted to become someone successful. Not the Luna who was afraid of being alone.

Just Luna.

A girl who had finally realized that nobody else should decide what her life was supposed to become.

Her hand moved across the page.

Slowly, she wrote:
“Let every person choose how their own story ends.”

The moment the final word appeared, nothing happened. Luna waited. The First Writer waited. Mira and Elara waited. The garden remained completely silent. For one second, Luna wondered if the book had rejected her sentence. Then the ink began to move.

The words Luna had written slowly spread across the page, not changing into different words, but moving outward like thin lines of light. They traveled from the final page into the pages before it. One page turned. Then another. Then another. The light moved through the book as though it was searching for every story that had ever been written inside it.

Luna stepped back.

“What is happening?” Mira whispered.

Luna shook her head. “I don't know.”

The First Writer immediately walked toward the book. “No.”

He looked at the pages. “No, no, no…”

His voice was different now. For the first time, he sounded confused. He reached for the book and tried to close it. The cover moved slightly. Then stopped. He tried again. Nothing. He looked at Luna.

“What did you write?”

Luna answered honestly. “You heard me.”

The First Writer looked back at the page. The sentence was still there. He read it again. Then again. His face slowly changed. At first, he looked confused. Then worried. Then afraid.

“I don't understand,” he whispered.

Luna looked at him. “Neither do I.”

The First Writer stepped backward. The book suddenly opened to another page. A name appeared. Then another. Then another.

Luna didn't recognize most of them. They were names from the previous writers. The people who had once found the book. The people who had written their wishes. The people who had given the book pieces of their freedom in exchange for the lives they wanted.

The pages began turning faster. A woman appeared in the garden. She looked around in confusion. A man appeared beside the old tree. Then another person. Then another.

Mira stared at them. “Who are they?”

Elara's eyes widened. “They're the writers.”

Luna looked around. The people who had disappeared were returning. Some looked frightened. Some looked confused. Some were crying.

Some simply stood still, as though they had forgotten what it felt like to breathe freely.

One elderly man looked down at his hands and whispered, “I'm free.”

A young woman began crying when she saw the garden. Another person looked toward the sky and laughed. They had all been trapped inside the stories they had once chosen. But now they were standing outside those stories.

Luna looked at the book. “What did my sentence do?”

The First Writer stared at her. “I don't know.”

It was the first time he had ever admitted that. The book turned another page. This time, the page showed a story Luna recognized. The story of a woman who had wanted to change her past. The woman had written a perfect childhood. Then the book showed the life of a man who had wanted success.

Then another person who had wanted love. Then another who had wanted to erase a painful memory. One by one, their stories appeared. And one by one, the pages became blank. Not because their lives were being erased.

Because the book was no longer holding their endings. Their stories were being returned to them. The First Writer looked horrified.

“Stop.” The book didn't stop.

He grabbed the cover. “Stop!”

Nothing happened. He tried to open a different page. The book refused to move for him. He looked at his hands. Then at the book. Then at Luna. “What did you do?” Luna shook her head. “I didn't write your story.”

“Then why isn't it listening to me?”

Luna looked at the book. She remembered the sentence she had written. Let every person choose how their own story ends. She slowly understood. The sentence wasn't giving the book a new person to obey. It was taking away the idea that the book needed someone to control it. Every person would now have their own story.

Their own choices. Their own ending. Including him.

Luna looked at the First Writer. "I think the book is doing what I asked."

"What did you ask it to do?"

"To let everyone choose."

The First Writer's face went pale. "But I created this book."

"Yes."

"It belongs to me."

"No," Luna said softly. "You created it. That doesn't mean you own everyone's choices."

The First Writer stepped toward her. "You don't know what you're doing."

Luna looked at him calmly. "No. I don't."

She looked at the people around them. "But neither do they."

She looked at Mira. "Neither does my sister."

She looked at Elara. "Neither does my mother."

Then she looked at herself. “And neither do I.”

The First Writer stared at her.

Luna continued, “That's what being free means.”

The book suddenly moved. It floated toward the First Writer. He stepped backward. For the first time, Luna saw something she had never seen before. The First Writer was afraid of the book. The cover opened by itself. A blank page appeared. Then words slowly began appearing on it. The First Writer's name.

He froze. “What is this?”

No one answered. The page continued writing.

Not Luna. Not Mira. Not Elara.

The book itself was opening his story.

The First Writer looked at Luna. “You did this.”

Luna shook her head. “No.”

“But you wrote the sentence.”

“Yes.”

“Then you wrote my ending.”

Luna looked at him. “No. I only gave you the same choice you wanted everyone else to have.”

The First Writer stared at the page. His own story was waiting for him.

For the first time, he was not the one holding the pen. He was the person standing in front of the page. And now, he had to face a story he could no longer control. The book slowly moved closer to him. The garden shook. The released writers stepped away. Mira held Luna's hand.

Elara stood beside her. Luna watched silently. She didn't know what would happen to the First Writer. And she didn't try to decide it. That was the whole point. The book had finally stopped asking one person to decide everyone's ending. The First Writer looked at his own page one last time.

His eyes filled with fear. Then the page turned. And he disappeared into his own story. The garden became completely silent. No one celebrated. No one spoke. Luna simply stood there, watching the place where he had been. Then the black book slowly floated back toward her.

It stopped in front of her. The cover was no longer cracked. The pages were no longer glowing. It looked almost like an ordinary black book. Luna reached toward it. But before her fingers touched the cover, the book closed itself. A soft sound echoed through the garden.

Click. Luna looked down. The book was gone.

Not destroyed. Not burned. Not broken.

Simply gone. She stared at her empty hands. Mira came closer. “Where did it go?” Luna didn't know. She looked at Elara. Her mother smiled gently. “Maybe that's the point.” Luna looked at the empty space where the book had been.

For once, she didn't need to know. She had spent her whole life searching for answers. Now she understood that some things could remain mysteries. She took Mira's hand. Then Elara's.

And together, they walked away from the fading garden. Behind them, the last traces of the magical world disappeared. But somewhere, in a place Luna could not see, something remained.

Not controlled. Not owned. Not destroyed.

Only waiting. And Luna had no idea... who would find it next...



Chapter 23 - The Book Closes

For several seconds after the black book disappeared, Luna remained exactly where she was, staring at the empty space in front of her. There was nothing there now. No black cover. No strange pages. No glowing words. Not even a small piece of paper remained behind. It was as if the book had never existed at all. The garden was becoming quieter with every passing second, and the strange light that had filled the trees was slowly fading into the early morning darkness.

Luna looked at her hands. She had expected to feel something when the book vanished—relief, happiness, maybe even fear. Instead, she felt strangely empty. For so long, the book had been part of every question she had asked. It had been the reason she searched for Elara, the reason she discovered Mira, the reason she learned about the First Writer. Now it was gone, and Luna suddenly realized that she no longer had anything to blame for the things she had lost. There was only her life, exactly as it was.

Mira came closer and gently touched Luna's shoulder. “Are you okay?” Luna looked at her sister and nodded, though she wasn't completely sure. “I think so.” Mira looked toward the place where the book had disappeared. “Do you think it's really gone?” Luna remained silent for a moment. “I don't know.” Elara walked toward them. Her face was calm, but Luna could see that she was also thinking about everything that had happened.

“Maybe it doesn't matter where it went,” Elara said. Luna looked at her. “Why?” Elara smiled softly. “Because it no longer belongs to anyone.” Luna looked down at the ground. She remembered the First Writer saying that the book belonged to him because he had created it. But now the book had no owner. It had no master. It had no person controlling its pages. Whatever happened to it next would not be decided by the First Writer anymore.

A sudden sound came from somewhere deep inside the garden. It was soft at first, like the sound of a single page turning. Luna looked around. Then another sound followed. And another. Soon, the entire garden seemed to whisper with the sound of pages. Mira held Luna's hand tightly. “What is that?” she asked. Luna didn't answer. The trees began to move, even though there was no wind.

The paths that had been disappearing suddenly became brighter. One by one, the doors that had appeared between the trees began opening. Behind each door was a different place. A small house. A city street. A quiet room. A train station. A school. A place Luna didn't recognize. They were all connected to the lives of the people who had been trapped inside the book.

The previous writers began walking toward the doors. Some stopped before leaving and looked back at Luna. A woman carrying an old notebook smiled at her. “Thank you,” she whispered. Luna shook her head. “I didn't free you.” The woman smiled. “Maybe not. But you reminded the book that our lives belonged to us.” She walked through the door and disappeared. Another man stood nearby, looking at the garden one last time. “I don't remember what I wrote anymore,” he said. “Maybe that's okay,” Luna answered. “You can write something new.” The man smiled for the first time and walked away. One after another, the writers left. Some knew exactly where they wanted to go. Some didn't. But that didn't matter anymore. They were free to decide.

Luna watched them disappear and realized something important. Freedom didn't mean knowing exactly what to do. Freedom meant being allowed to decide, even when you didn't know. The First Writer had always been afraid of uncertainty. That was why he had tried to remove it from every life. He thought that if people knew their future, they would never be hurt. But Luna now understood that a future without uncertainty wasn't really a future at all. It was only a plan someone else had made.

She looked at Mira and remembered how many years her sister had been missing from her memories. She looked at Elara and remembered how much pain her mother's absence had caused. None of it had been easy. But if Luna changed everything now, she would also erase the choices that had brought them to this moment. She didn't want that anymore.

Then Luna noticed something strange.

The garden had stopped fading.

She looked around in surprise. “Why isn't it disappearing?” Mira asked. Luna looked toward Elara. Her mother didn't answer immediately. Instead, she looked toward the far end of the garden. There stood the doorway through which the First Writer had disappeared. It was completely black. No light came from inside it. No sound came from behind it. Luna slowly walked closer. She didn't want to enter. She only wanted to understand what had happened. When she reached the doorway, she saw a single page lying on the ground. It wasn't black. It wasn't glowing. It looked like an ordinary sheet of paper.

Luna picked it up.

There was only one sentence written on it.

The story belongs to the one who lives it.

Luna read the sentence twice.

Then she understood that the First Writer's story had finally ended—not because Luna had written an ending for him, but because he had lost the ability to write everyone else's.

The doorway slowly closed.

The last thing Luna saw was the First Writer standing far away inside the darkness. He wasn't looking at her anymore. He was looking at his own story. There were no other people around him. No magical book. No perfect world. No one waiting for him to decide what happened next. For the first time, he was completely alone with the life he had created for himself. Luna felt a strange sadness when she saw him.

She had hated what he had done, but she finally understood that she didn't need to punish him herself. His choices already belonged to him. The doorway closed completely, and the First Writer disappeared from the world of the book forever. The moment it closed, the garden began to change.

The magical trees slowly became ordinary trees. The strange flowers became simple flowers. The glowing paths disappeared. The sky turned lighter. The walls of the garden began dissolving into tiny pieces of light that floated upward like dust in the morning sun. Luna stood quietly beside Mira and Elara as the place that had held so many secrets slowly disappeared. She realized she was going to miss it. Not because it had been beautiful, but because it had been the place where she finally understood the truth about her family.

Mira looked at Luna. “Are you sad?”

“A little.”

“Why?”

“Because it feels like I'm losing everything again.”

Elara gently held Luna's hand. “But this time, you're not losing us.”

Luna looked at her mother.

“Are you really coming home?”

Elara smiled. “If you still want me there.”

Luna didn't answer with words. She simply hugged her. Mira joined them. For a long moment, the three of them stood together while the garden disappeared around them. There was no perfect music. No magical light. No beautiful words appearing in the air. Just three people holding on to each other after years of being separated.

And somehow, that felt more real than any perfect world the First Writer could have created. The ground beneath them suddenly became bright. Luna closed her eyes. She heard Mira's voice. Then Elara's. Then the sound of something closing.

A single soft sound. Click. Luna opened her eyes.

The garden was gone. The black book was gone. The First Writer was gone. The previous writers were gone. Everything magical had disappeared. Only the memory remained. Luna looked around. She was standing in a familiar room. Her apartment. The same walls. The same window. The same small desk. The same chair where she had spent countless nights writing. For a moment, she wondered if she had imagined everything. She looked at the desk. There was no black book. Only her ordinary notebook.

She walked toward it slowly. She touched the cover. Nothing happened. She opened it. Every page was blank. Luna smiled faintly. Maybe that was how it should be. She looked toward the window. Morning light was entering the room. Outside, people were beginning their ordinary day. Cars moved along the road. Someone was watering plants on a balcony. A child was laughing somewhere nearby.

The world looked completely normal. But Luna wasn't the same person who had gone into the garden. She had entered that world wanting to control her past. She had come back understanding that she couldn't. She had entered wanting answers. She had come back knowing that some mysteries could remain mysteries. She had entered believing that a perfect life would make her happy. She had returned knowing that a free life was worth more. Luna sat at her desk. She looked at the blank notebook. For the first time, the empty page didn't frighten her.

It felt like a beginning. She picked up her pen. Then stopped. She smiled. "No more endings." She closed the notebook. And just as she stood up, there was a knock at the door.

Luna froze. She looked toward the entrance. Another knock came. Slow. Gentle. Familiar. Her heart began beating faster. She walked toward the door. She placed her hand on the handle. And before she opened it, she heard a voice from the other side.

"Luna?" Her eyes filled with tears. It was Mira. Luna opened the door. Mira was standing there. And behind her stood Elara. For a few seconds, Luna couldn't speak.

She simply stared at them.

Not as memories. Not as rewritten characters. Not as people inside a magical story. But as real people standing in front of her. Her family.

Elara smiled. "We're home."

Luna stepped forward and hugged them both. This time, she didn't ask the book to make the moment last forever. She didn't ask what tomorrow would bring.

She didn't ask whether they would always stay together. She simply held them. Because now she knew something she had never understood before. A moment did not have to last forever to be precious. A life did not have to be perfect to be beautiful.

And a story did not need a perfect ending to be worth living. That night, after Mira and Elara had gone to sleep, Luna sat alone at her desk. She looked at the empty space where the black book had once been. Nothing was there.

She whispered, “Goodbye.”

Then she opened her notebook. The first page was completely blank. Luna smiled. She picked up her pen. And began to write. She didn't know what would happen tomorrow. She didn't know how her story would end. But for the first time, she didn't need to know. Because the next page belonged to her.



Chapter 24 - Home

The morning came quietly.

Luna opened her eyes before the sunlight had fully entered the room. For a few seconds, she didn't move. She simply lay there, looking at the ceiling and listening to the familiar sounds of her apartment. A vehicle passed somewhere outside. A bird called from a nearby building. The old fan above her made a soft clicking sound as it turned. Everything was normal. There was no strange garden, no glowing path, no voice from a black book, and no pages turning by themselves. Luna slowly sat up and looked toward her desk.

Her notebook was still there, exactly where she had left it the night before. She stared at it for a long moment, wondering whether everything that had happened was truly real. Then she noticed something that made her heart suddenly beat faster. There was a faint smell of coffee coming from the living room.

Luna stepped out of her room.

She stopped.

Someone was standing near the window.

It was her father.

For a moment, Luna couldn't speak. He was holding a cup in one hand and looking outside, just as he used to do when she was little. His hair had become slightly greyer over the years, and there were tired lines around his eyes that Luna had never noticed when she was younger. But she knew him immediately. He turned when he heard her footsteps and smiled.

“Good morning.” Luna stood there, staring at him.

Her father frowned slightly. “Luna?”

She took one step toward him. Then another. “Dad…”

Her voice broke on the word. He placed the cup down and walked toward her. Luna suddenly felt the same ache she had carried for years return to her chest. There had always been something missing from her family, something she could never explain. Her mother had disappeared. Mira had disappeared from her memories. And through all those years, her father had been the one person who remained beside her, even when he couldn't understand why she seemed to carry a sadness she could never explain.

Now Luna finally understood how much he had also lost. She walked into his arms. Her father held her tightly. For a while, neither of them said anything. There was no magic in that moment.

No mysterious sentence. No book. Just a father holding his daughter.

“I thought I was going to lose you too,” Luna whispered.

Her father slowly pulled away and looked at her. “You were never going to lose me.”

Luna looked down. “I know.”

He gently touched her head, the way he had when she was a child. “You look like you haven't slept.” Luna gave a small laugh through her tears. “I didn't.”

“Why?” She almost told him everything.

The garden. The book. The First Writer.

Mira. Elara.

The previous writers. But then she realized something. Her father didn't need to know every impossible detail to understand what mattered. So she simply said, “I found something I had forgotten.” Her father looked at her carefully.

“And?”

Luna smiled. “I found my family.”

He didn't ask another question. Instead, he hugged her again. Behind them, a small sound came from the kitchen.

“Are you two going to stand there all morning?”

Luna turned.

Mira was standing in the doorway, holding two plates and looking at them with an amused expression.

Luna laughed. Her father looked at Mira for a long moment, as if his eyes were trying to understand what they were seeing. Then the plate in his hand slipped slightly, and his face suddenly changed. His eyes widened with disbelief, and a smile slowly appeared through the tears in his eyes.

“Mira?”

Mira stood still. He took a step toward her, almost afraid that she might disappear if he moved too quickly.

“My little girl…”

His voice trembled as he reached for her. For a moment, Mira didn't know what to say. Then she smiled and stepped into his arms. Her father held her tightly, laughing and crying at the same time.

“I thought I would never see you again.”

And for that one moment, after all those lost years, he wasn't looking at a mystery or a forgotten memory. He was simply looking at his daughter.

Luna asks, 'Are you awake?'

Mira rolled her eyes. “Unfortunately.”

Her father smiled. For the first time in a very long time, the apartment didn't feel empty. It felt full. Full of voices. Full of footsteps. Full of small arguments and quiet laughter. Full of people who belonged there.

Luna walked toward the kitchen with them. Mira placed the plates on the table while her father poured coffee. Luna sat down and looked around. It was such an ordinary scene that it almost made her emotional again. She had once believed that if she could change her past, she would need to create some huge, beautiful life where nothing ever went wrong. But sitting there with her father and Mira, Luna realized she had been looking for happiness in the wrong place. Happiness wasn't a perfect world. Sometimes it was simply having someone ask whether you wanted more food.

Mira pushed a plate toward Luna. “Eat.”

Luna smiled. “You sound like Mom.”

Mira immediately became quiet. The room changed. Luna looked toward the doorway. Elara was standing there. For a moment, nobody moved. Luna's father slowly turned toward her. His face changed completely. The cup in his hand almost slipped.

“Elara?”

Elara looked at him. She didn't say anything at first. Years of silence stood between them. Years of questions. Years of memories that had never been explained. Luna looked from her father to her mother. She suddenly understood that this moment belonged to them too. Her father took a slow step forward.

“Is it really you?”

Elara nodded. “Yes.”

His eyes filled with tears. “You came back.”

Elara smiled sadly. “I did.”

He looked at Luna. Then Mira. Then back at Elara.

“So this is what happened?”

Elara lowered her eyes. “I wish I could explain everything.”

Her father shook his head. “You don't have to explain everything today.”

Elara looked surprised.

He continued softly, “You're here. That's enough for now.”

Luna felt tears gather in her eyes.

For years, she had imagined her family reunion as something dramatic. She had imagined everyone crying, asking questions, demanding answers, trying to understand every missing piece of the past.

But real life was different. Sometimes people came back carrying things they couldn't explain. Sometimes forgiveness came before understanding. Sometimes being together was more important than knowing every answer. Luna walked toward her parents and gently took both their hands. Mira came beside her. The four of them stood together. Luna looked at them.

Her father. Her mother. Her sister. Her family.

Not a family created by the book. Not a family written into a perfect world. Not a family Luna had forced into existence.

A family that had found its way back to one another. And somehow, that made it more beautiful. Later that afternoon, Luna and Mira went through the old boxes stored inside the cupboard. Her father brought them one after another and placed them on the floor. There were photographs, letters, school certificates, old birthday cards, tiny toys, and things Luna had completely forgotten about. Mira found a photograph of the two of them as children and laughed.

“Look at your hair!”

Luna looked at it.

“My hair was cute.”

“It was terrible.”

“It was cute.”

Their father laughed from across the room.

“You both used to fight about everything.”

Luna looked at him. “Everything?”

He nodded. “Everything. Who got the bigger piece of cake. Who sat beside Mom. Who got to choose the television channel.”

Mira smiled. “Sounds like us.”

Luna looked at the photograph again. She realized something strange. Her memories weren't returning all at once. They were returning through ordinary things. A photograph. A voice. A smell. A familiar room.

Her father's laugh. Mira's smile. Elara's hands.

She didn't need the book to bring her memories back. She simply needed time. And maybe that was the real gift she had been given. Not perfect memories. Not a perfect past. Just the chance to remember naturally. As evening arrived, Luna stood near the window with her father. The sky was turning orange.

He looked at her. “You seem different.”

Luna smiled. “I am.”

“Better?”

She thought for a moment. “Not perfect.”

Her father smiled. “Good.”

Luna looked at him. “Why good?”

“Because nobody needs to be perfect.”

She laughed softly. “You and Mom both say things like that now.”

Her father looked toward Elara, who was talking with Mira in the other room.

“Maybe we finally learned it.”

Luna rested her head against his shoulder. For a few minutes, they simply watched the sunset. She didn't ask him what tomorrow would bring. She didn't ask whether everything would stay this way. She didn't ask whether the book could ever return. She had finally learned to live without needing an answer before the question had even been asked.

That night, the four of them sat together for dinner. Mira told a funny story. Her father laughed. Elara smiled. Luna listened. She looked around the table and suddenly remembered something the First Writer had never understood.

A life wasn't beautiful because nothing bad happened. A life was beautiful because people were free to experience it.

They could laugh. They could cry. They could make mistakes. They could forgive. They could change. They could leave. They could return.

And nobody could know exactly where the story would take them. After dinner, Luna returned to her room. Her father passed by the doorway and stopped.

“You're writing again?”

Luna looked at the blank notebook on her desk. “Yes.”

“What are you writing about?”

Luna smiled. “I don't know yet.”

Her father nodded. “Then that's a good beginning.”

He closed the door gently. Luna sat at her desk. She opened the notebook. The first page was completely blank. She picked up her pen. For a moment, she thought about writing the story of the black book. But she stopped. That story had already changed her.

She didn't need to trap it on a page. Instead, she turned to a fresh page. She wrote one simple sentence. Today, I came home. Luna looked at the words. Then she smiled. She didn't write another sentence. Not yet. She didn't need to. For the first time, she was comfortable with an unfinished page. She closed the notebook and turned off the light.

The apartment became quiet. Her family was asleep in the rooms around her. Her father was home. Her mother was home. Mira was home. And Luna was home too. She closed her eyes. For the first time in years, she didn't feel like she was waiting for something to return. She had spent so long searching for the ending of her story. Now she understood. Home was never the ending. It was the place where the next page could begin.

Chapter 25 - The Story She Chose

The apartment was quiet when Luna woke the next morning. For a few seconds, she didn't remember the dream. She only remembered the strange feeling it had left behind, as though she had been standing somewhere far away and had forgotten how she got there. She slowly opened her eyes and looked around her room. Morning light was coming through the curtains, falling softly across her desk. Her notebook was still there.

Her pen was lying beside it. Everything looked normal. Luna sat up and tried to remember the dream again. She could see darkness. She could see a familiar table. She could see a black book. She could see its pages opening by themselves. And then she remembered the sentence that had appeared. I have been waiting for you. Luna's heart beat a little faster. She looked toward the empty space beside her notebook, almost expecting to see the black cover sitting there. But there was nothing. She slowly let out a breath. “Just a dream,” she whispered.

She got out of bed and walked into the living room. Her father was already awake. He was standing near the kitchen, trying to make breakfast while Mira sat at the table and complained that he was putting too much salt into everything. Elara was sitting near the window, watching them with a small smile. Luna stood at the doorway for a moment and simply watched. Her father noticed her and smiled. “You're finally awake.” Luna nodded. “Good morning.” Mira looked at her. “You look like you saw a ghost.” Luna laughed softly.

“Maybe I saw something strange in my dream.” Her father immediately looked at her with concern. “Bad dream?” Luna shook her head. “Not exactly.” He placed a plate on the table. “Then eat first. You can tell us later.” Luna smiled and sat down beside Mira. For the first time, she realized how ordinary this moment was—and how much she loved it.

There were no mysterious rules. No magical powers. No perfect future waiting to be written. Just her family sitting together in the morning.

After breakfast, Luna returned to her room. Her father followed her to the doorway and noticed the notebook on her desk. “Still writing?” he asked. Luna nodded. “I think I want to finish something.” He smiled. “Then finish it.” Luna looked at him. “What if I don't know how it ends?” Her father leaned against the doorway. “Then don't start with the ending.” Luna smiled.

“What should I start with?” He shrugged. “Whatever comes next.” Those simple words stayed with her. Whatever comes next. She had spent so much of her life trying to know what came next that she had forgotten she could simply live it. Her father left the room, closing the door gently behind him. Luna sat down at her desk and opened her notebook. The page she had written the night before was still there. Today, I came home. She looked at the sentence for a long time. Then she turned the page.

Luna began to write. She wrote about a girl who spent years believing that every painful thing in her life needed to be fixed. She wrote about a mysterious book that promised to change the world with a single sentence. She wrote about a mother who disappeared because she refused to control her daughter's future. She wrote about a little sister whose memory had been taken away because someone believed forgetting would keep her safe. She wrote about a man who wanted to create a perfect world but forgot that people needed the freedom to choose even when their choices could hurt them.

She wrote about writers who lost themselves inside stories they had tried to control. She wrote about a girl who finally stood in front of the last page and understood that the most important thing she could write was not an ending, but a choice. She stopped after a while and looked at what she had written. It wasn't exactly the story that had happened to her.

It wasn't completely different either. It was something in between. Some parts were memories. Some were questions. Some were things she still didn't fully understand. She didn't try to make everything perfect. She didn't change the painful parts. She didn't remove the mistakes. She simply allowed them to remain. For the first time, Luna wasn't writing to escape her life. She was writing because she wanted to understand it. The stories she had once created to hide from loneliness now became a way of looking at the world with open eyes.

Hours passed. The sunlight moved across the room. Mira came in once to ask whether Luna wanted lunch. Her father called from the kitchen twice because she didn't hear him the first time. Elara came in quietly and placed a cup of tea beside her notebook without interrupting her.

Luna smiled at each of them and continued writing. Every time she looked up, someone she loved was there. And every time she returned to the page, she remembered the choice she had made.

She could never control how long those moments would last. She could never promise that nobody would leave again. She could never write a future where nothing hurt. But she could choose how she lived the next moment.

By evening, Luna had reached the end of her story. She stared at the last page. Her pen remained still in her hand. She knew that this was the part where writers usually wrote the final sentence. The part where everything was explained.

The part where every mystery was solved and every character was given a perfect ending. But Luna didn't want that anymore. She thought about the black book. She thought about the First Writer. She thought about the sentence she had written. Let every person choose how their own story ends.

She realized that perhaps the most important part of that sentence was not ends.

It was choose.

So Luna wrote: “You don't need to know how your story ends to have the courage to write the next page.”

She looked at the sentence. Then she placed the pen down. She didn't add anything else. The story was finished. But the page wasn't. There was still space beneath the sentence.

Luna smiled. That empty space no longer felt like something missing. It felt like possibility. She closed the notebook. Outside her room, she heard her father's voice calling everyone for dinner. Mira complained that he had made the same food again. Elara laughed. Her father laughed too. Luna stood up and walked toward the door.

Then she stopped. Something had caught her attention. A tiny sound.

Flip. Luna turned around. Her notebook was still closed. She looked at it for a few seconds. Nothing happened. She slowly walked back to the desk and placed her hand on the cover. Nothing. She opened the notebook. The pages were exactly as she had left them.

Blank. Ordinary.

Luna smiled to herself. “I'm imagining things.”

She closed the notebook again. Then she left the room. The apartment door closed behind her. The room became silent. For several minutes, nothing moved. Then the curtains shifted slightly. A soft breeze passed through the room.

The notebook remained still. But beside it, on the empty part of the desk, a tiny black mark appeared. It was no larger than a dot. The mark slowly spread. A black cover began forming beneath it.

No sound. No light. No magic in the air.

Just a book. A completely black book with no title. No author's name. No sign that anyone had written it. It simply appeared. The cover opened by itself. One page turned. Then another. The pages were blank. Until the book reached the first page. For a long moment, nothing happened. Then dark letters slowly appeared.

The same words Luna had seen when everything began.

I have been waiting for you.

The page remained open. The book waited. Not for Luna. Not for the First Writer. Not for someone who wanted a perfect life. It simply waited for whoever would find it next. And somewhere, far away from Luna's apartment, someone was walking home alone. They passed an old building.

They noticed something lying near the entrance. A black book. They stopped. They looked around. There was no one there. Slowly, they bent down and picked it up. The book was warm. They turned it over. There was no title. No author's name. They opened the first page. Their eyes moved across the words.

“I have been waiting for you.”

And somewhere, beyond everything Luna could see, the story began again. But this time, there was no First Writer waiting to control it. There was no one who could decide what this person's life should become.

The book had changed. Its purpose had changed. Its rules had changed. Now, if someone wanted to use it, they would have to make their own choice. And every choice would have a price. Because the book could still give someone what they asked for.

It could still make a wish real. But the freedom to choose would always remain the most important thing. Luna would never know who found the book next. She would never know what they would write. She would never know whether they would use it or walk away. And for once, she was completely okay with that.

Because Luna had finally learned that not every story needed to be controlled. Some stories needed to be lived. Some pages needed to remain blank. Some endings needed to remain unknown. And some books were better left waiting. Luna opened the door to the dining room.

Her father looked up from the table. “You're coming?”

Luna smiled. “Yeah.”

Mira moved her chair to make space for her. Elara looked at her daughter and smiled. Luna sat down between the people she loved. Her father passed her a plate. Mira started telling another story. Elara laughed. Luna laughed with them. And somewhere in the world, a black book waited for its next reader. Luna didn't know what her story would become tomorrow.

She didn't need to. She had finally understood the truth. The story was never about finding the perfect ending. It was about having the courage to choose the next page. And this time the story was hers. But there was one thing Luna never knew. The book had not disappeared. It had only disappeared from her world. Somewhere, perhaps in a room you have never seen, on a table you have never noticed, there may be a black book with no title and no author's name.

Maybe it is closed. Maybe it is already open. Maybe its first page is still blank. Or maybe... someone has already touched it. Because the book is no longer waiting for Luna. **It is waiting for you.**

So before you close this story, look around you. Check the table beside you. Look at the corner of your room. Look between the books you already own. Because if you happen to find a black book with no name on its cover... Don't be so sure that you found it.

What if it found you?

And if you open the first page... you might see the words Luna once saw: **I have been waiting for you.**

THE END.

